Escola Superior de Tecnologia e Gestão de Águeda

Universidade de Aveiro

English Applied to Computer Science

Higher Professional Training Course in Network and Computer Systems

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Cofinanciado por:

CENTRO 2030 PORTUGAL 2030 Cofinanciado pela União Europeia

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Unit 1 – Operating Systems

1. Do you know the OS that appear in the image below? Which is your favourite and why?

2. What is an OS? Fill in the gaps with words from the box below.

on | off | command | format | office | permissions | applications | terminate | architecture | kernel | share | optimized | non | multitasking | Linux | Unix | pre-installed | graphical | drivers

An operating system is a generic term for the a) ______________ software layer that lets you perform a wide array of 'lower level tasks' with your computer. By low-level tasks we mean:

- the ability to log b) ______________ with a username and password
- log c) ______________ the system and switch users
- d) ______________ storage devices and set default levels of file compression
- install and upgrade device e) ______________ for new hardware
- install and launch applications such as word processors, games, etc.
- set file f) ______________ and hidden files
- g) ______________ misbehaving applications

A computer would be fairly useless without an OS, so today almost all computers come with an OS h)__________________________. Before 1960, every computer model would normally have its own OS custom programmed for the specific i)_______________________of the machine's components. Now it is common for an OS to run on many different hardware configurations. At the heart of an OS is the j)_________________________, which is the lowest level, or core, of the operating system. It is responsible for all the most basic tasks of an OS such as controlling the file systems and device drivers.

The most popular OS today is Microsoft Windows, which has about 85% of the market k)__________________________ for PCs and about 30% for servers. But there are different types of Windows OSs as well. Some common ones still in use are Windows 98, Windows 2000, Windows XP, Windows Vista, and Windows Server. Each Windows OS is l) _____________________for different users, hardware configurations, and tasks.

There are many more operating systems out there besides the various versions of Windows. Free BSD, Solaris, Linux and Mac OS X are some good examples of m) _______________________-Windows operating systems.

An OS must have at least one kind of user interface. Today there are two major kinds of user interfaces in use, the n) __________________________line interface (CLI) and the o) __________________________ user interface (GUI). Right now, you are most likely using a GUI, but your system probably also contains a CLI as well.

Examples of popular operating systems with GUI interfaces include Windows and Mac OS X. p)__________________________systems have two popular GUIs as well, known as KDE and Gnome, which run on top of X-Windows. A great example of an up and coming OS is Ubuntu. Ubuntu is a q) __________________________ operating system which is totally free, and ships with nearly every application you will ever need already installed. Even a professional quality r) __________________________suite is included by default.

What's more, thousands of free, ready-to-use s) _______________________can be downloaded and installed with a few clicks of the mouse. This is a revolutionary feature in an OS and can save lots of time, not to mention hundreds or even thousands of dollars on a single PC. Not surprisingly, Ubuntu's OS market share is growing very quickly around the world.

As an IT professional, you will probably have to learn and master several, if not all, the popular operating systems. If you think this sort of thing is fun and interesting, then you have definitely chosen the right career).

source: http://www.english4it.com/index.php?req=reading (adapted)

3. Which are the OS's main functions? Complete the sentences below with the given words.

instructions | access rights | programs | interface |
backing store | files | processing time | memory | peripherals

In any computer, the OS:

a) Controls the ________________ and ________________ such as printers

b) Deals with the transfer of ________________ in and out of memory

c) Organises the use of ________________ between programs

d) Organises ________________ between programs and users

e) Maintains security and ________________ of users

f) Deals with errors and user ________________

g) Allows the user to save ________________ to a backing store

h) Provides the ________________ between the user and the computer

4. Complete each gap in these sentences with the appropriate form of the correct verb from the list below.

back up | catch up | free up | set up | start up | update | upgrade | upload

a) To avoid losing data, you should ________________your files regularly.

b) You can ________________your PC by adding a new motherboard.

c) Delete some files to ________________space on your hard disk.

d) Data is ________________from regional PCs to the company's mainframe each night.

e) The operating system boots up when you ________________ your computer.

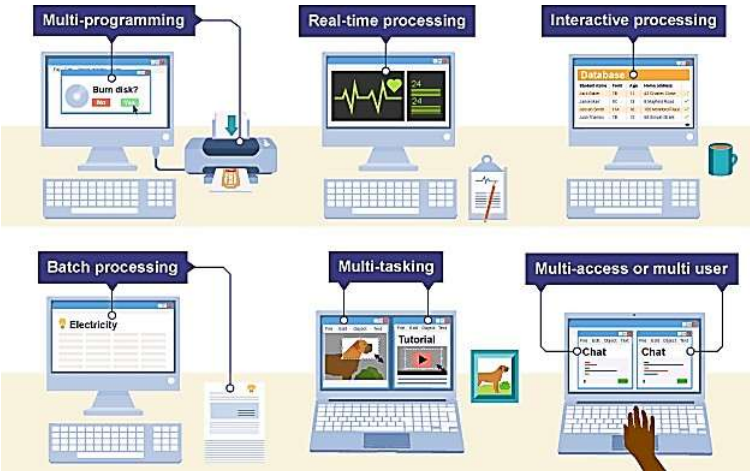
f) She's taking a course to ________________her knowledge of computing.

g) The computer checks the memory when it ________________.

h) He ________________a website to advertise his business.

i) If you miss a class, you can study the presentations to ________________.

5. Associate the different <u>modes of operation</u> to the following texts.



a) ______________________________: is used when the computer has to react within a guaranteed time to an input. It does not necessarily have to be fast. It simply has to be quick enough to respond to inputs in a predictable way. Computers using this mode of operation are often dedicated to the control of systems such as industrial processes, planes and space flights.

b) ______________________________**:** is a method of operating in which several programs appear to be running at once. It switches jobs in and out of processor time according to priority. For example, while one job is being allocated printer time, another will be being processed in memory. The processor is so fast that it seems that many jobs are being processed at the same time.

c) ______________________________**:** it is where programs or data are collected together and processed in one go. Typically, the processing of payrolls, electricity bills, invoices and daily transactions are dealt with this way. This method of operation lends itself to jobs with similar inputs, processing and outputs where **no human intervention** is needed. Jobs are stored in a queue until the computer is ready to deal with them.

d) ______________________________**:** This system is used when the tasks on the computer system require a continual exchange of information between the user and the computer system. It can be seen as the opposite of batch processing.

e) ______________________________**:** This is not just about running more than one application at the same time. It allows various tasks to run concurrently, taking turns using the resources of the computer. This can mean running a couple of applications, sending a document to the printer and downloading a web page.

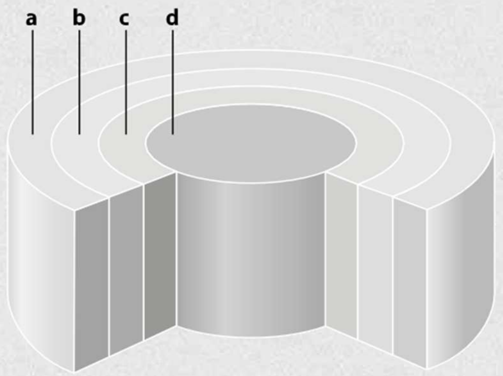
f) ______________________________**:** In this mode of operation, several users can use the same system together via a LAN. The CPU deals with users in turn; clearly the more users, the slower the response time. Generally, however, the processor is so fast that the response time at the most is a fraction of a second and the user feels they are being dealt with immediately.

source: http://www.bbc.co.uk/education/guides/z8vrd2p/revision/2 (adapted)

6. Match the labels to the four layers of this diagram with the help of the diagram caption.

☐	applications programs
☐	User
☐	Hardware
☐	operating system

A CONCEPTUAL DIAGRAM OF AN OPERATING SYSTEM



Closest to the user are applications programs – software that helps a user compute a payroll or play a game or calculate the trajectory of a rocket.

The operating system is the set of programs between the applications programs and the hardware.

7. Read the following text carefully and answer the questions below.

OPERATING SYSTEMS: HIDDEN SOFTWARE

When a brand-new computer comes off the factory assembly line, it can do nothing. The hardware needs software to make it work. Are we talking about applications software such as word processing or spreadsheet software? Partly. <u>But</u> an applications software package does not communicate directly with the hardware. Between the applications software and the hardware is a software interface - an operating system. An operating system is a set of programs that lies between applications software and the computer hardware.

The most important program in the operating system, the program that manages the operating system, is the supervisor program, most of which remains in memory and is <u>thus</u> referred to as resident. The supervisor controls the entire operating system and loads into memory other operating system programs (called non-resident) from disk storage only as needed.

An operating system has three main functions: 1) manage the computer's resources, <u>such as</u> the central processing unit, memory, disk drives, and printers, 2) establish a user interface, and 3) execute and provide services for applications software. Keep in mind, <u>however</u>, that much of the work of an operating system is hidden from the user. In particular, the first listed function, managing the computer's resources, is taken care of without the user being aware of the details. <u>Furthermore</u>, all input and output operations, <u>although</u> invoked by an applications program, are actually carried out by the operating system.

7.1. Find synonyms for the underlined words.

______________________ ______________________

______________________ ______________________

______________________ ______________________

7.2. Try to find the answers to the following questions.

a) What difference is there between applications software and operating systems?

b) Why is the supervisor program the most important operating system program?

c) What is the difference between resident and non-resident programs?

d) What are the main functions of an operating system?

7.3. Complete the gaps in this summary of the text on operating systems using these linking words and phrases:

although	because	but
in addition	such as	therefore

The user is aware of the effects of different applications programs 1) ______________ operating systems are invisible to most users. They lie between applications programs, 2) ______________ word processing, and the hardware. The supervisor program is the most important. It remains in memory, 3) ______________ it is referred to as resident. Others are called non-resident 4) ______________ they are loaded into memory only when needed. Operating systems manage the computer's resources, 5) ______________ the central processing unit. 6) ______________, they establish a user interface, and execute and provide services for applications software. 7) ______________ input and output operations are invoked by applications programs, they are carried out by the operating system.

8. Work in Pairs:

Student A: You are a sales representative trying to sell your company's laptop. You are presenting your product to the Sales Director of a manufacturing company which is thinking of buying 30 units for their staff. Decide on the specs and complete the table below. Then try to persuade the Sales Director to buy your product.

Name	______________________
Type (size)	______________________
Processor type	______________________
Operating speed	______________________
Memory	______________________
Display	______________________
Cost	______________________
Other features	______________________

Useful Expressions

- *It costs…*
- *It runs/ operates on…*
- *It weighs…*

Student B: You are the Sales Director of a manufacturing company. You are considering buying 30 laptops for your sales staff. Find out about all the specifications of the model on offer. Decide whether it is suitable for your needs.

Useful Expressions

- *How much does it cost?*
- *What power source does it use?*
- *How big/heavy is it?*

Unit 2 – User Interfaces

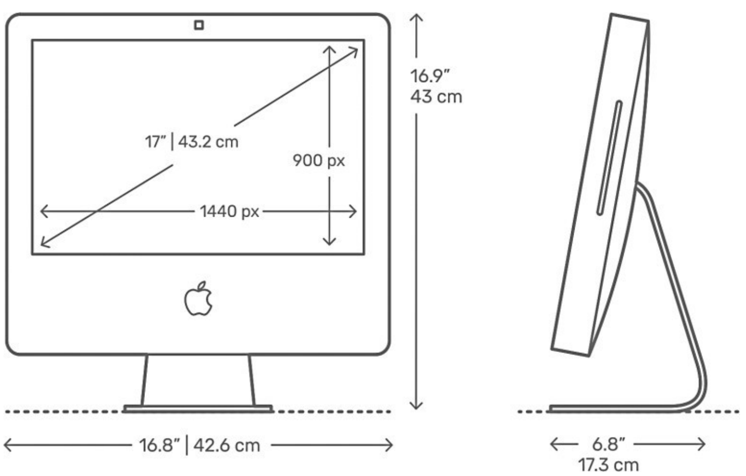
1. Match the words to their synonyms.

1. width	________	**a)** altitude
2. measurements	________	**b)** breadth
3. size	________	**c)** capacity
4. height	________	**d)** dimensions
5. length	________	**e)** distance
6. volume	________	**f)** scale

2. Find out the missing words.

Adjective	**Noun**	**Verb**
deep	1.	5.
high	2.	6.
long	3.	7.
wide	4.	8.

3. Area: length, width, depth and height. We use the nouns length, width, depth and height and the adjectives long, wide, deep and high to talk about area and size:



Example

"The Apple iMac Intel Plastic 17" (2006) <u>has</u> a **height of** 16.9" (43 cm), **width** of 16.8" (42.6 cm), **depth** of 6.8" (17.3 cm), and weighs 15.5 lb (7 kg). The screen size is 17" (43.2 cm) with a resolution of 1440 x 900 px".

A: How **wide** is it?

B: It <u>is</u> 16.8" (42.6 cm) **wide**.

A: My work desk is only 40 cm **deep**. Will it fit?

B: Definitely. It <u>is</u> 6.8" (17.3 cm) **deep**, so that's perfect.

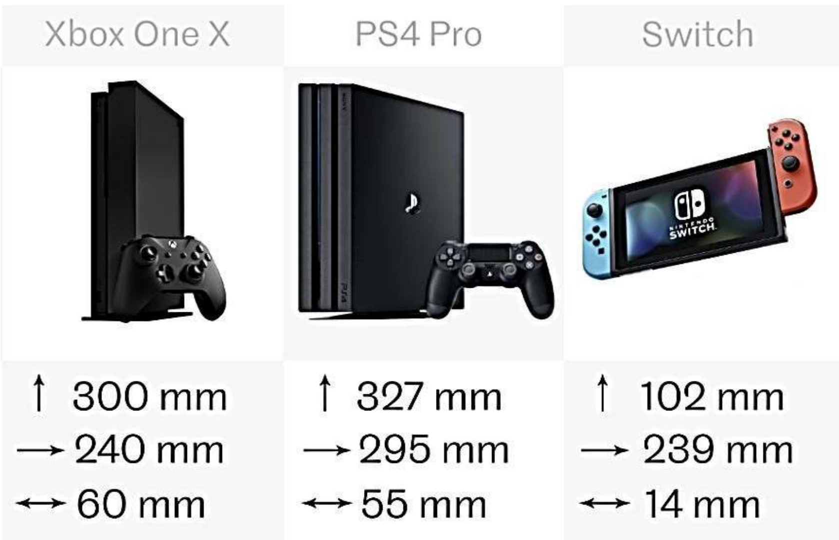
Tips:

- We can use **by** instead of long and wide:

  The wall is ten meters long and two meters high. - The wall is 10 meters ***by*** *2 meters.*

- Tall or high? We use **tall** for people, buildings and things that grow. Otherwise we use **high**.

3.1. Use the information in the table below to write sentences comparing the gaming systems.



3.2. Look at the picture of the work station below and describe it as thoroughly as you can.

3.3. Now describe the desk below using the actual measurements.

4. Answer the following questions:

a. What features are commonly found on a computer desktop?

b. How do users typically start programs through a Graphical User Interfaces (GUI)?

5. The pictures below illustrate user interfaces based on graphics.

5.1. Match the interface elements with the following definitions.

a)	window	______a menu that the user 'pulls down' from a name in the menu bar at the top of the screen by selecting the name with the mouse
b)	dock	______graphic images (or intuitive symbols) used to represent an object or task
c)	toolbar buttons	______containers for documents and applications
d)	folders	______found at the top of a window, they take you to the Home folder and others.
e)	icons	______set of icons at the bottom of the screen that give you instant access to the things you use most
f)	pull-down menu	______an arrow, controlled by the mouse, that allows you to move around the screen
g)	the pointer	______a viewing area less than or equal to the screen size. By using different windows, you can work on several documents or applications simultaneously

5.2. Identify the following interface elements in the pictures above.

a) window	**b)** scroll bars	**c)** menu bar	**d)** pull-down menu
e) pointer	**f)** toolbar buttons	**g)** disk icons	**h)** folders
i) program icons	**j)** document icons	**k)** printer icon	**l)** dock icons

6. Read the manual and answer the questions below.

<u>Starting Mailbag Deluxe</u>

Follow these instructions to start Mailbag Deluxe after installation. This process applies to all standard GUIs.

a. Find the shortcut to Mailbag Deluxe on your desktop. The icon is a folder with a star in the corner.

b. Right-click the icon to show the dropdown menu.

c. Select the option that says “Open Mailbag”.

d. The setup guide will open. Click “Next”.

e. Type your name and email address. Make sure the cursor appears in the correct box.

f. Click “Finish Setup”. This step may take a few moments.

g. Click “Run Mailbag”. You are ready to use Mailbag Deluxe!

6.1. Mark the following statements as True (T) or False (F).

a) The instructions help users install a program. ________

b) “Open Mailbag” is an option from the dropdown menu. ________

c) The cursor takes a few moments to appear in the correct box. ________

6.2. Choose which word or phrase best fits each blank.

icon | user | organise | dropdown menu

a) A(n) ____________________________operates a computer.

b) A(n) ____________________________can represent a file, program, or folder.

c) A(n) ____________________________provides a list of options when clicked on by a user.

d) ____________________________a desktop by arranging the icons on it.

6.3. Identify the sentences that use the words correctly.

a) The user clicked on the <u>cursor</u> to start the web browser.

b) Some people display pictures on their <u>desktops</u>.

c) Clicking on a menu option will often <u>run</u> a program.

d) Use the <u>icon</u> to scroll down to the bottom of the page.

7. Read the manual and answer the questions below.

GUIs

The term ***user interface*** refers to the standard procedures the user follows to interact with a particular computer. A few years ago, the way in which users had access to a computer system was quite complex. They had to memorize and type a lot of *commands* just to see the content of a disk, to copy files or to respond to a single prompt. In fact, only experts used computers, so there was no need for a user-friendly interface. Now, however, computers are used by all kinds of people and as a result there is a growing emphasis on the user interface.

A good user interface is important because when you buy a program you want to use it easily. Moreover, a graphical user interface saves a lot of time: you don't need to memorize commands in order to execute an application; you only have to point and click so that its content appears on the screen.

Macintosh computers – with a user interface based on graphics and intuitive tools – were designed with a single clear aim: to facilitate interaction with the computer. This interface is called WIMP: **Window, Icon, Menu (or Mouse)** and **Pointer** and software products for the Macintosh have been designed to take full advantage of its features using this interface. In addition, the ROM chips of a Macintosh contain libraries that provide program developers with routines for generating windows, dialogue boxes, icons and pop-up menus. This ensures the creation of applications with a high level of consistency.

Today, the most innovative GUIs are the Macintosh, Microsoft Windows and IBM OS/2 Warp. These three platforms include similar features: a desktop with icons, windows and folders, a printer selector, a file finder, a control panel and various desk accessories. Double-clicking a folder opens a window which contains programs, documents or further nested folders. At any time within a folder, you can launch the desired program or document by double-clicking the icon, or you can drag it to another location.

The three platforms differ in other areas such as device installation, network connectivity or compatibility with application programs.

These interfaces have been so successful because they are extremely easy to use. It is well known that computers running under an attractive interface stimulate users to be more creative and produce high quality results, which has a major impact on the general public.

a) What is the contribution of Macintosh computers to the development of graphic environments?

b) What does the acronym 'WIMP' stand for?

c) What computing environments based on graphics are mentioned in the text?

d) How do *you* run a program *on* a computer with a graphical interface?

8. Verbs + object + infinitive; verbs + object + to-infinitive. Study the examples and fill in the gaps with the correct form of the verb.

Examples

- A GUI *lets you point* to icons and click a mouse button to execute a task.
- A GUI *allows you to* use a computer without knowing any operating system commands.
- The X Window System *enables Unix-based computers* to have a graphical look and feel.
- Voice recognition software *helps disabled users (to) access* computers.

Allow, enable and permit are used with this structure:

Verb + object + to-infinitive

Let is used with this structure:

Verb + object + infinitive

Help can be used with either structure.

a) Adding more memory lets your computer ____________________(work) faster.

b) The MouseKeys feature enables you _________________(use) the numeric keypad to move the mouse pointer.

c) ALT + TAB allows you ____________________(switch) between programs.

d) ALT + PRINT SCREEN lets you _________________(copy) an image of an active window to the Clipboard.

e) The StickyKeys feature helps disabled people ________________(operate) two keys simultaneously.

9. Mobile UI Design. Match the different types of screen with the descriptions.

a) splash screen	____aims at presenting the app to the user, its features, and how useful it may be
b) home screen	____is the screen shown while an app is loaded
c) profile screen	____is where the users' questions can be answered by a real operator or using chatbots
d) settings screen	____is a place to store personal information
e) onboarding screens	____is the starting point of the user journey
f) conversational screen	____allows for users to align the app with their preferences

10. Navigation elements. Read the text and underline the technical terms used to clarify the interactive elements, i.e. menu, CTA, bar, button, switch and picker.

The aspect of helpful and seamless navigation in UI should be thought out from the early stages of creating the user interface. Users are navigated via an interface with a number of interactive elements such as buttons, switches, links, tabs, bars, menus, fields and the like, some of which will be described more in detail below.

Menu is one of the core navigation elements. It is a graphical control that presents the options of interaction with the interface. Basically, it can be the list of commands - in this case, options will be presented with verbs marking possible actions like, for example, “save”, “delete”, “buy”, “send” etc. Menu can also present the categories along which the content is organized in the given interface, and this can be the high time for using nouns marking them. Menus can have different locations in the interface (side menus, header menus, footer menus, etc.) and different ways of appearance and interaction (drop-down menus, drop-up menus, sliding menus, etc.)

Behind the widely used abbreviation **CTA**, designers and content creators mean a call to action. This is actually the word of phrase which stimulates users to interact with a product in a way and for the aim it is designed for. CTA elements are the interactive controls that enable users to do the action they are called to. Typical types of such interactive elements in the layout are buttons, tabs, or links. The active CTA elements are clickable buttons informing users that after clicking they can see more information on the particular topic.

Bar is a section of the user interface with clickable elements enabling a user to quickly take some core steps of interaction with the product or it can also inform the user on the current stage of the process. Among the basic types of bars, we could mention:

- Tab bar - in mobile applications, it appears at the bottom of an app screen and provides the ability to quickly switch between different app sections.
- Loading bar - the control informing the user on the current stage of action when the process is in the active stage and the user can see the flow via timing or percentage shown in progress.
- Progress bar - provides feedback on a result of the current process so far, for example, showing how much of the planned activity has been done.

Button is the element that enables a user to get the appropriate interactive feedback from the system within a particular command. Generally speaking, a button is a control with which the user directly communicates to the digital product and sends the necessary commands to achieve a particular goal, like, let's say, send the email, buy a product, download the data, turn on the player and tons of other possible actions.

- Hamburger button – the button hiding the menu: clicking or tapping it, a user sees the menu expanding. It is called so as its form consisting of three horizontal lines looks like a typical bread-meat-bread hamburger. Nowadays it is a typical interaction element, still highly debatable due to the number of pros and cons.
- Plus button - the button that being clicked or tapped presents the ability to add new content, be it a new contact, post, note, position in the list - anything user could do like the basic action with the digital product. Sometimes, tapping this button, users are directly transferred to the modal window of creating content, in other cases, there is also a medium stage when they are given additional options to choose from and make adding the particular piece of data more focused.
- Share button - the button enabling a user to share the content or achievement directly to social networking accounts. In the vast majority of cases, it is presented with icons that present a brand sign of particular social networks and are easily recognizable.

These differ from a **switch**, given that the latter is a control that enables users to switch an option on or off.

Finally, the **picker** allows users to pick the point from the row of options. It usually includes one or several scrollable lists of distinct values, for example, hours, minutes, dates, measurements, currencies, etc. Scrolling the list, users choose and set the needed value. This type of interactive element is widely used in the interfaces which have the functionality of setting time and dates.

source: [UI/UX Design Glossary. Navigation Elements] (adapted)

10.1. Using the words underlined in the text above, identify the interactive elements of your favourite mobile app and describe their purpose/ features.

Unit 3 – Computer Applications

1. How would you define the term 'Computer Software'? Listen to an extract from a lecture on computer software. Identify the most important key words.

2. Listen to the extract once more and fill in the gaps with the correct terms.

For as long as there has been computer hardware, there has also been computer software. But what is software?

Software is just instructions written by a ____________________ [1] which tells the computer what to do. They are also known as '____________________'[2].

Nothing much is simple about software. Software programs can have millions of ____________________ [3]. If one line doesn't work, the whole program could break! Even the process of starting software goes by many different names in English. Perhaps the most correct technical term is '____________________'[4], as in "the man executed the computer program." Be careful, because this term also means (in another context) to put someone to death! Some other common verbs used to start a software program you will hear are '__________________'[5], '____________________'[6], and even '____________________'[7] (when the software in question is an operating system).

Software normally has both features and bugs. Hopefully more of the former than the latter! When software has a bug there are a few things that can happen. The program can ________________________ [8] and ____________________ [9] with a confusing message.

This is not good. ____________________ [10] do not like confusing ____________________ [11] such as:

site error: the file /home7/businfc6/public_html/blog/wordpress/wp-content/plugins/seo-blog/core.php requires the ionCube PHP Loader ioncube_loader_lin_5.2.so to be installed by the site administrator.

Sometimes when software stops responding you are forced to manually ________________ [12] the program yourself by pressing some strange combination of keys such as ctrl-alt-delete.

Because of poor usability, documentation, and strange error messages, programming still seems very mysterious to most people. That's too bad, because it can be quite fun and rewarding to ____________________ [13] software. To succeed, you just have to take everything in small steps, think very hard, and never give up.

I think everyone studying Information Technology should learn at least one programming language and write at least one program. Why? Programming forces you to think like a computer. This can be very rewarding when dealing with a wide range of IT-related issues from tech support to setting up PPC (pay-per-click) advertising campaigns for a client's web site. Also, as an IT professional, you will be dealing with programmers on a daily basis. Having some understanding of the work they do will help you get along with them better.

Software programs are normally written and compiled for certain hardware _______________ [14]. It is very important that the software is _________________ [15] with all the components of the computer. For instance, you cannot run software written for a Windows computer on a Macintosh computer or a Linux computer. Actually, you can, but you need to have special emulation software or a virtual machine installed. Even with this special software installed, it is still normally best to run a program on the kind of computer for which it was intended.

There are two basic kinds of software you need to learn about as an IT professional. The first is ______________________ [16] or proprietary software, which you are not free to modify and improve. An example of this kind of software is Microsoft Windows or Adobe Photoshop. This software model is so popular that some people believe it's the only model there is. But there's a whole other world of software out there.

The other kind of software is called ___________________ [17] software, which is normally free to use and modify (with some restrictions of course). Examples of this type of software include most popular programming languages, operating systems such as Linux, and thousands of applications such as Mozilla Firefox and Open Office.

3. Match the descriptions on the left with these famous applications.

1.	word processor	**a.**	_____Adobe Photoshop
2.	spreadsheet	**b.**	_____Internet Explorer
3.	virus protection	**c.**	_____Microsoft Word
4.	browser	**d.**	_____Microsoft Excel
5.	image editor	**e.**	_____Microsoft PowerPoint
6.	media player	**f.**	_____Norton AntiVirus
7.	email software	**g.**	_____Outlook Express
8.	presentation software	**h.**	_____Adobe PageMaker
9.	graphic design software	**i.**	_____RealPlayer

4. Read the text below and complete it with the correct form of the words in brackets.

Without software 1) __________________ (apply), it would be very hard to actually perform any 2) __________________ (meaning) task on a computer unless one was a very talented, fast, and patient programmer. Applications are meant to make users more 3) ______________ (produce) and get work done faster. Their goal should be 4) ________________ (flexible), efficiency, and 5) __________________ (user-friendly).

Today there are thousands of applications for almost every purpose, from writing letters to playing games. Producing software is no longer the lonely profession it once was. Software is a big business and the cycle goes through certain stages and versions before it is released. Applications are released in different versions, including alpha versions, beta versions, release candidates, trial versions, full versions, and upgrade versions. Even an application's 6) ________________ (instruct) are often included in the form of another application called a help file.

Alpha versions of software are normally not released to the public and have known bugs. They are often seen 7) ____________(intern) as a 'proof of concept'. Avoid alphas unless you are desperate or else being paid as a 'tester'.

Beta versions, sometimes just called 'betas' for short, are a little better. It is common practice nowadays for companies to release public beta versions of software in order to get free, real-world testing and feedback. Betas are very popular and can be downloaded all over the Internet, normally for free. In general you should be wary of beta versions, especially if program 8) ____________(stable) is important to you. There are exceptions to this rule as well. For instance, Google has a history of excellent beta versions which are more stable than most company's releases.

After the beta stage of software 9) ____________(develop) come the release candidates (abbreviated RC). There can be one or more of these candidates, and they are normally called RC 1, RC 2, RC 3, etc. The release candidate is very close to what will actually go out as a feature complete 'release'.

The final stage is a 'release'. The release is the real program that you buy in a shop or download. Because of the 10) ____________(complex) in writing PC software, it is likely that bugs will still find their way into the final release. For this reason, software companies will offer patches to fix any major problems that end users complain loudly about.

5. In 2020, Forbes announced that the total number of mobile apps on the planet has reached a massive 8.93 million. Most people know the more common apps, but can you work out what the following apps do? Write down what their names suggest.

- S.M.T.H. (Send Me To Heaven)
- iBeer
- MovieLingo

5.1. Using a search engine, search for and describe 3 strange apps.

Name	Description
1.	
2.	
3.	

6. **Writing an app review.** Have you ever read reviews on any of these websites?
   - Amazon
   - Appbot
   - Techadvisor
   - PCmag

6.1. What sort of information do you hope to get from the reviews?

6.2. Do the reviews influence your decision to buy something or use a product?

7. **Read the following review about STRAVA, an activity tracking app and fill in the gaps with the missing prepositions.**

What is Strava?

Strava is an activity tracking app that primarily tracks GPS-based activity. Like any GPS app, it runs 1) in the background while you do your thing. You can use it to run, walk, cycle, hike, canoe, skate, kayak, kitesurf, ski, row, snowboard, snow snowshoe, stand up paddle, surf, swim, and more.

Pros	**Cons**
Rich set of features. Strong emphasis on community. Supports many fitness trackers.	Privacy concerns. Expensive Premium membership.

Ease of Use

The app is easy to use. The download takes almost no time and is free of charge. You can sign 2) __________via Facebook (which enables you to see friends already using STRAVA), however this means you will have to adjust privacy settings 3) ______the Facebook website – not the mobile app or mobile website. You have the option to fill 4) ________a quick profile with a photo, age, gender, height, and weight, which plays a role in calculating calories.

When we are ready to start, all you have to do is select an activity. The opening screen has a very large 'start' button. This starts the timer, and you are ready to roll.

Features

Depending 5) _________the activity and plan, STRAVA tracks distance, moving time, elevation, calories, speed, heart rate, and average temperature.

Strava syncs 6) _________a variety of other fitness trackers and running watches, so you don't need to carry a phone 7) _________ you to use it. Although the app (which is available 8) _______Android and iOS) offers some privacy settings, you must be willing to make some personal information public, specifically your geolocation data, to get the full Strava experience.

A surprisingly fun aspect of STRAVA is the social connectivity of the program. You are able to 'follow' other athletes, which shows their recent activities 8) ______your feed.

You can also sign 9) ________for challenges according to the activity you want to do. Some challenges, like virtual races, have a leaderboard where you can compete 10) _____other members while streak challenges ask you to complete a certain number of activities 11) _______ a consecutive number of weeks.

Pricing and Plans

Like many fitness apps, Strava has a freemium model. You can use the app 12) ___free with some limitations. You still get to compete with the free version, but you don't have advanced stats and a number of other features.

It costs €7.99 13) __________month or €59.99 if you pay 14) __________an annual subscription upfront.

Downsides

Tracking activity is seamless but drains battery life. I recently took Strava 15) _____a five-hour day hike, thinking a hike would be a great activity to track since it would be based 16) ____my location. It certainly worked well for tracking my route, but it had used 17) ________almost all of my phone's battery power.

On the other hand, Strava depends on GPS 18) ______recording activities. In some devices, the GPS does not work properly and Strava will not record effectively.

The bottom line

Strava is the go-to fitness app for competitive types, but the company needs to do more to address privacy and security concerns.

Sources: https://mashable.com/review/strava-app-review - 26/05/2021
https://mashable.com/review/strava-app-review - 20/04/2018

8. **Writing a review.** A review should be a direct suggestion or opinion on a product's pros and cons. It should be transparent when it comes to sharing important details like price and features and also reflect your technical expertise.

Key steps when writing a software/app review:

1. Use the software/app (and make notes)
2. List key aspects such as PROS, CONS, FEATURES and PRICE
3. Add images and videos (particularly if you are writing for the web). This will help readers to see how the software actually looks like and inform their decision.
4. Make information easy to understand (e.g. highlight the most important information and don't be afraid to use bullet points, tables and columns)
5. Suggest/discuss alternative products
6. Give your genuine personal feedback

8.1. Bearing in mind the tips above, use the template below to write a review on an app you use on a regular basis.

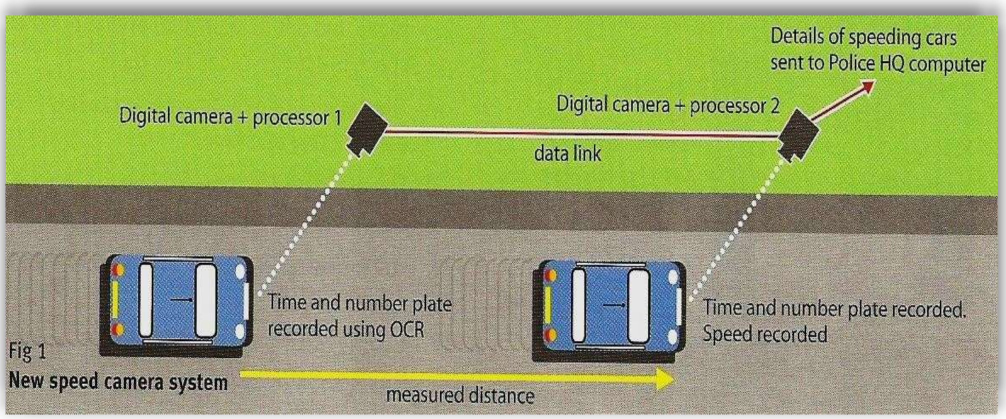
APP REVIEW Template

Name of the app	
Synopsis[1]	
Pros and cons[2]	
Features[3] **Pricing and Plans** **Alternatives**	
Personal feedback	
Bottom line[4]	

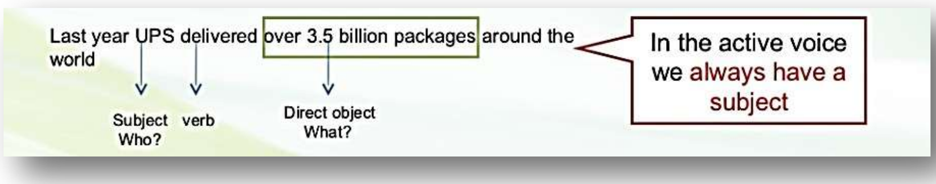
a) Short description of the app: type and main purpose(s).
b) Table outlining advantages and disadvantages.
c) Review - Describe the key features of the app based on your experience. 50-80 words
d) Final recommendation and rating.

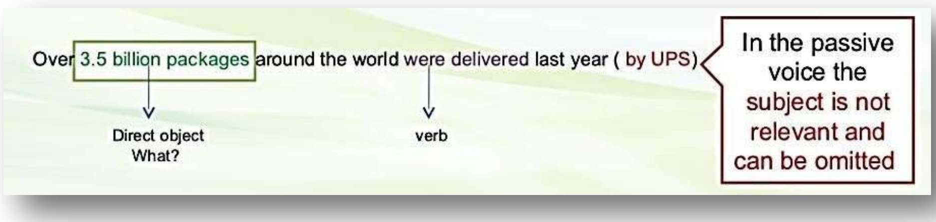
9. ICT is used in everyday life to replace or enhance applications which were previously paper or manually based. **Study the diagram below. Using only the diagram, try to list each stage in the operation of this computerized speed trap to make an explanation of how it operates.**

For example: Camera 1 records the time each vehicle passes.

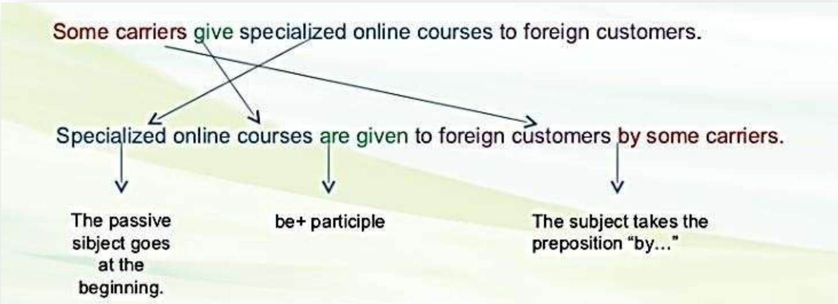


1. We often use the passive voice to describe processes, especially if we are more interested in the action than in the person (or entity) who does the action. Take a close look at the example.





2. Most of the times, the passive voice is used when we do not know who the subject is. If you want to mention <u>the subject</u>, you have to do it by using the <u>preposition BY</u>. Another important aspect is that you have to use the verb <u>TO BE + PARTICIPLE</u>. Look at the example below.



3. If you want to change a sentence from active to passive voice, you have to make sure that the <u>verbs match in tense and number with the receiver</u>. Look at the examples.

	Active voice	Passive voice
Simple present	The scanner reads the smart tag in the package	The smart tag in the package is read by the scanner
Simple past	Gillette reduced its errors in shipment	Shipment errors were reduced by Gillete
Present perfect	Consumer groups have studied the impact of shipment in the final price of foreign goods.	The impact of shipment in the price of foreign goods has been studied by consumer groups.
Past perfect	The unloaders had packed the parcels when Louis came into the office.	The parcels had been packed by the unloaders when Louis came into the office.

9.1. Describe the operation of the new speed trap by converting each of these statements to the Passive Voice. Add information on the agent where you think it is necessary.

a) The first unit records the time each vehicle passes.

b) It identified each vehicle by its number plates using OCR software.

c) It relays the information to the second unit.

d) The second unit is also recording the time each vehicle passes.

e) The microprocessor will calculate the time taken to travel between the units.

f) It relays the registration numbers of speeding vehicles to police headquarters.

g) A computer will match each vehicle with the DVLC database.

h) It prints off a letter to the vehicle owners using mailmerge.

Unit 4 – Networks

1. Read the following product listing and answer the questions below.

NetNine's X-Series is the cutting edge of networking equipment for home and office. Select a product name for more detailed information.

X50 Wireless Router

The X50 Router offers the best in coverage, security, and energy efficiency. Minimal setup is required. Once connected to a DSL or cable modem, the router will double as a wireless access point. Requires CAT-5 cable.

X-series Ethernet Hub

The X-series 4-port Ethernet Hub is perfect for home office and small business use. Connects up to four devices. Requires CAT-5 cable

X-series Ethernet Switch

The X-series 8-port Ethernet Switch is the finest of high-performance networking devices. Its lightning-fast switching makes it the ideal choice for time-sensitive applications. Like other X-series products, our Ethernet Switch is highly energy efficient. Connects up to eight devices. Requires CAT-5 cable.

X37 USB Wireless Network Adapter

Compatible with any USB-equipped laptop or desktop computer, the X37 Wireless Network Adapter provides user-friendly access to local wireless networks. Built-in antenna and ultra-compact design makes the X37 model less vulnerable to damage. Setup is quick and secure. Perfect for travel.

a) **What is the purpose of the text?**

b) **Which product connects the most devices?**

c) **Why do so many devices require CAT-5 cable?**

2. Listen to an extract from a lecture on networks and answer these questions:

2.1. What does LAN stand for?

____

2.2. Where are LANs usually located?

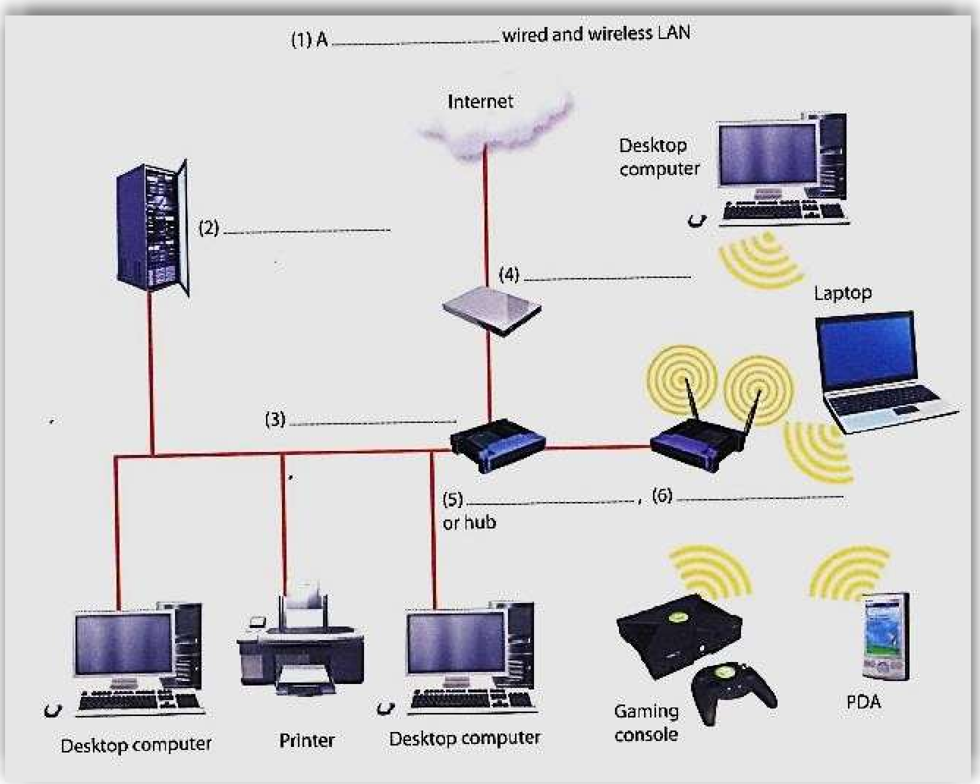
____

2.3. What is the difference between a wired LAN and a wireless LAN?

____

____

3. Label the elements of this LAN.



4. Choose the correct word in each of the following.

4.1. The speed with which a modem can process data is measured in ________.

a) bandwidth b) bits per second (bps) c) signal

4.2. Cables consisting of several copper wires each with a shield are known as ________ cables.

a) twisted pair b) optical fibre c) power cables

4.3. Computers that are connected together within one building form a ________.

a) WAN b) ISP c) LAN

4.4. If you transfer a file from a remote computer to your computer, you ________.

a) download b) upload c) run

4.5. To send out information is to ________.

a) signal b) packet c) transmit

4.6. A document containing information and graphics that can be accessed on the internet is ________.

a) a website b) a web page c) the World Wide Web

5. Complete the words in the following sentences by adding the prefix *inter-*, *intra-*, *trans-*, *com-*, *con-*, *up-* or *down-*.

a) Last month computer ______time cost the company over €10,000 in lost production.

b) The computers in the production department have now been successfully _connected with those in the planning department.

c) Once you have completed payment details the data will be ______mitted via a secure link.

d) We cannot network these computers because the systems are not ______patible.

e) Many companies distribute internal documents on their own _______net.

f) Once the home page has been completed, we'll be ready to _______load the site.

g) Cables are being laid throughout the building as the network requires physical_______nections.

h) Using the network he was able to ______bine the data from different reports.

6. Here is a list of instructions for someone wanting to set up a small network. Put the instructions in the correct order.

a) Make wiring and layout plans for your network. _________

b) Hook up the network cables by connecting everything to the hub. _________

c) Check that each computer has an IP address and give it a name. _________

d) If you're installing a small network, twisted pair will be adequate. However, in order to span greater distances and to minimize magnetic and electrical interference use fibre optic cable. __

e) Decide on the type of network you want to install. To enable you to transfer large amounts of data, choose Fast Ethernet (100BaseT). _____

f) Install network adapters in the computers. _________

g) Add an internet gateway to your network to set up a shared internet connection. _________

h) Install driver software for the adapter driver and install client software to share printers and files. ________

i) Check which protocols are installed and add any other protocols you require. _________

j) Get the hardware you need: an Ethernet adapter card for each computer that doesn't have an Ethernet port, a hub if you've got more than two computers, cables and wall jacks. __

7. Read the following text carefully and answer the questions below.

Networks

LANs (Local Area Networks)

Networking allows two or more computer systems to exchange information and share resources and peripherals.

LANs are usually placed in the same building. They can be built with two main types of architecture: peer-to-peer, where the two computers have the same capabilities, or client-server, where one computer acts as the server containing the main hard disk and controlling the other workstations or nodes, all the devices linked in the network (e.g. printers, computers, etc.).

Computers in a LAN need to use the same protocol, or standard of communication. Ethernet is one of the most common protocols for LANs. A router, a device that forwards data packets, is needed to link a LAN to another network, e.g. to the Net.

Most networks are linked with cables or wires but new Wi-Fi, wireless fidelity, technologies allow the creation of WLANs, where cables or wires are replaced by radio waves. To build a WLA you need access points, radio-based receiver-transmitters that are connected to the wired LA, and wireless adapters installed in your computer to link it to the network. Hotspots are WLANs available for public use in places like airports and hotels, but sometimes the service is also available outdoors (e.g. university campuses, squares, etc.).

Network topology

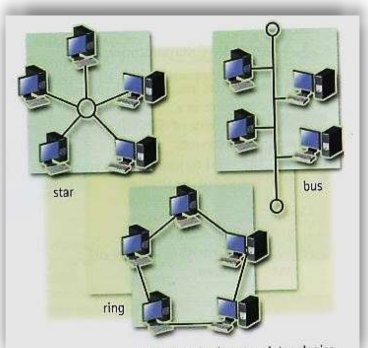
Topology refers to the shape of a network. There are three basic physical topologies.

• **Star**: there is a central device to which all the workstations are directly connected. This central position can be occupied by a server, or a hub, a connection point of the elements of a network that redistributes the data.

• **Bus**: every workstation is connected to a main cable called a bus.

• **Ring**: the workstations are connected to one another in a closed loop configuration.

There are also mixed topologies like the tree, a group of stars connected to a central bus.



The three basic network topologies

WANs (Wide Area Networks)

WANs have no geographical limit and may connect computers or LANs on opposite sides of the world. They are usually linked through telephone lines, fibre-optic cables or satellites. The main transmission paths within a WAN are high-speed lines called backbones.

Wireless WANs use mobile telephone networks. The largest WAN in existence is the Internet.

7.1. Correct the following statements.

a) LANs link computers and other devices that are placed far apart.
b) In a client-server architecture, all the workstations have the same capabilities.
c) The word protocol refers to the shape of the network.
d) Routers are used to link two computers.
e) Access points don't need to be connected to a wired LAN.
f) Wireless adapters are optional when you are using a WLAN.
g) Hotspots can only be found inside a building.
h) The Internet is an example of a LAN.
i) Wireless WANs use fibre and cable as linking devices.

8. Use the words in the box to complete the sentences.

LAN | WLAN | nodes | peer-to-peer | hub | server | backbones

a) All the PCs on a ___________________are connected to one __________________, which is a powerful PC with a large hard disk that can be shared by everyone.

b) The style of ___________________ networking permits each user to share resources such as printers.

c) The star is a topology for a computer network in which one computer occupies the central part and the remaining ___________________are linked solely to it.

d) At present Wi-Fi systems transmit data at much more than 100 times the rate of a dial-up modem, making it an ideal technology for linking computers to one another and to the Net in a ____________________.

e) All of the fibre-optic ___________________of the United States, Canada and Latin America cross Panama.

f) A ____________________joins multiple computers (or other network devices) together to form a single network segment, where all computers can communicate directly with each other.

9. Identify the topologies of communication networks described below.

a) All the devices are connected to a central station._______________

b) In this type of network there is a cable to which all the computers and peripherals are connected.______________

c) Two or more star networks connected together; the central computers are connected to a main bus.______________

d) All devices (computers, printers, etc.) are connected to one another forming a continuous loop.______________

Unit 5 – Internet security

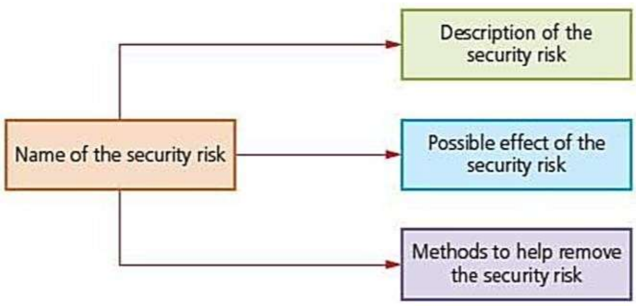
1. Match the words or phrases with the definitions below.

hacker | cyber heist | breach | challenge | fraudster | malware | legacy system |

spur on | cyber stress test | phishing | ramp up | stakeholder

a) a computer simulation technique used to see how well a company can function in a series of difficult situations ________________
b) a person who uses a computer to connect to other people's computers secretly and often illegally to find, change or use information ________________
c) a situation in which someone discovers information that should be kept secret ________________
d) something that requires a lot of skill, energy and determination to deal with ________________
e) computing software that is designed to damage or destroy information on a computer ________________
f) a computer system that is still used although it is no longer the most modern or advanced, because it would be very expensive or difficult to replace it ____________
g) to increase something, such as a rate or a level ________________
h) to encourage someone to do something or cause something to happen ________________
i) the practice of trying to trick someone into giving their secret bank information by sending them an email that looks as if it comes from their bank and that asks them to give their account number or password ________________
j) someone who commits the crime of obtaining money from people by tricking them ________________
k) someone who has an interest in the success of a plan, system or organisation ________________
l) an organised attempt by thieves to steal something online ________________

2. Security of data. Read the text below and follow the model diagram to summarize the key information. For each security risk, write a short description, its possible effects and how to minimize it.



Security of data

There are a number of security risks associated with any electronic device that connects to a network (internet or mobile phone networks being the most common), namely: Hacking; Phishing; Pharming; Spyware; Viruses; Spam.

Hacking

Hacking is the act of gaining access to a computer system or network without legal authorisation. Although some hackers do this as a form of intellectual challenge, many do it with the sole intention of causing harm (e.g. editing/deleting files, installing harmful software, executing files in a user's directory or even committing fraud).

Although the only fool proof way of stopping a networked computer from being hacked into is to disconnect it from the internet, this is clearly not a practical or desirable solution. Similarly, the only certain way to prevent a stand-alone computer from being hacked into is to keep it in a locked room when not in use; again, this is not always practical.

However, there are a number of ways to minimise the risk of hacking:

- use of firewalls: these are used on networked computers. They provide a detailed log of incoming and outgoing traffic and can control this traffic. They are able to stop malicious traffic getting to a user's computer and can also prevent a computer connecting to unwanted sites and from sending personal data to other computers and sites without authorization.
- use of robust passwords (i.e. difficult passwords to guess) and user IDs to prevent illegal access to a computer or internet site.

Phishing

Phishing is a fraudulent operation involving the use of emails. The creator sends out a legitimate-looking email, hoping to gather personal and financial information from the recipient of the email. To make it more realistic (and therefore even more dangerous!) the message will appear to have come from some legitimate source (such as a famous bank). As soon as an unsuspecting user clicks on the link they are sent to a spoof website where they will be asked for personal information including credit card details, PINs, etc. which could lead to identity theft.

Many ISPs now attempt to filter out phishing emails, but users should always be aware that a risk still exists and should be suspicious of any emails requesting unsolicited personal details.

Variations of phishing include smishing (short for SMS phishing) and vishing (voice mail phishing).

Pharming

Pharming is a scam in which malicious code is installed on a computer hard disk or a server. This code has the ability to misdirect users to fraudulent websites, usually without their knowledge or consent.

Whereas phishing requires an email to be sent out to every person who has been targeted, pharming does not require emails to be sent out to everybody and can therefore target a much larger group of people much more easily. Also, no conscious action needs to necessarily be made by the users (such as opening an email), which means they will probably have no idea at all that they have been targeted. Basically, pharming works like this:

A hacker/pharmer will first infect the user's computer with a virus, either by sending an email or by installing software on their computer when they first visit their website. It could also be installed as part of something the user chooses to install from a website (so the user doesn't necessarily have to open an email to become infected). Once infected, the virus would send the user to a fake website that looks almost identical to the one they really wanted to visit. Consequently, personal information from the user's computer can be picked up by the pharmer/hacker.

Certain anti-spyware, anti-virus software or anti-pharming software can be used to identify this code and correct the corruption.

Spyware

Spyware is software that gathers user information through their network connections without them being aware that this is happening. Once spyware is installed, it monitors all key presses and transmits the information back to the person who sent out the spyware. This software also has the ability to install other spyware software, read cookies and even change the default home page or web browser. Anti-spyware can be used to search out this software and correct the corruption.

Viruses

A virus is a program that replicates (copies) itself and is designed to cause harm to a computer system. It often causes damage by attaching itself to files, leading to one or more of the following effects. i.e. causing the computer to crash (e.g. to stop functioning normally, lock up or stop responding to other software) and loss of files - sometimes system files are lost which leads to a computer malfunction or corruption of the data stored on files.

Viruses infect computers through email attachments and through illegal software or downloading of files from the internet that are infected. The following list shows ways of protecting systems against viruses:

- Use up-to-date anti-virus software. This detects viruses and then removes or quarantines (i.e. isolates) any file/attachment which has been infected.
- Do not allow illegal software to be loaded onto a computer and do not use any CD/DVD in the computer which comes from an unknown source.
- Only download software and files from the internet if they are from a reputable site.
- Use firewalls on networks to protect against viruses.

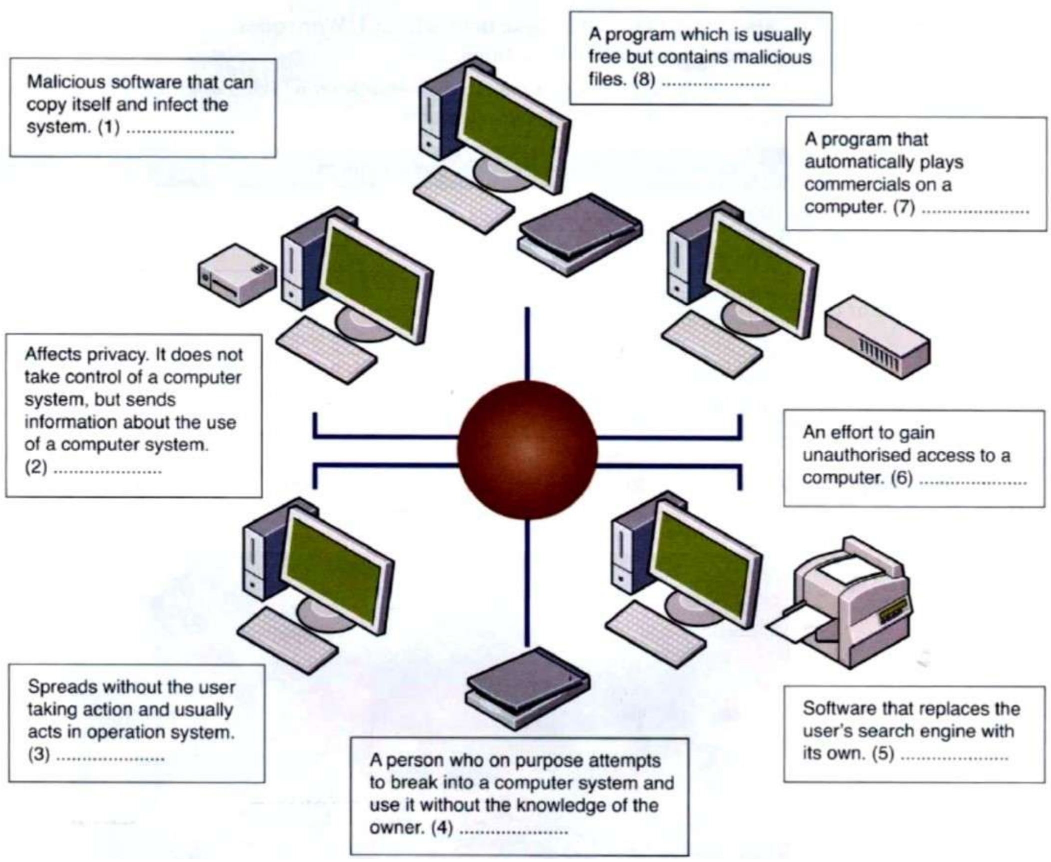
Spam

Spam is electronic junk mail and is a type of advertising from a company sent out to a target mailing list. It is usually harmless but it can clog up the networks, slowing them down, or fill up a user's mailbox. It is therefore more of a nuisance than a security risk.

Many ISPs are good at filtering out spam. In fact, some are so efficient that it is often necessary to put legitimate email addresses into a contacts list/address book to ensure that wanted emails are not filtered out by mistake.

2. Read the descriptions 1–8 and match the words in below to the descriptions.

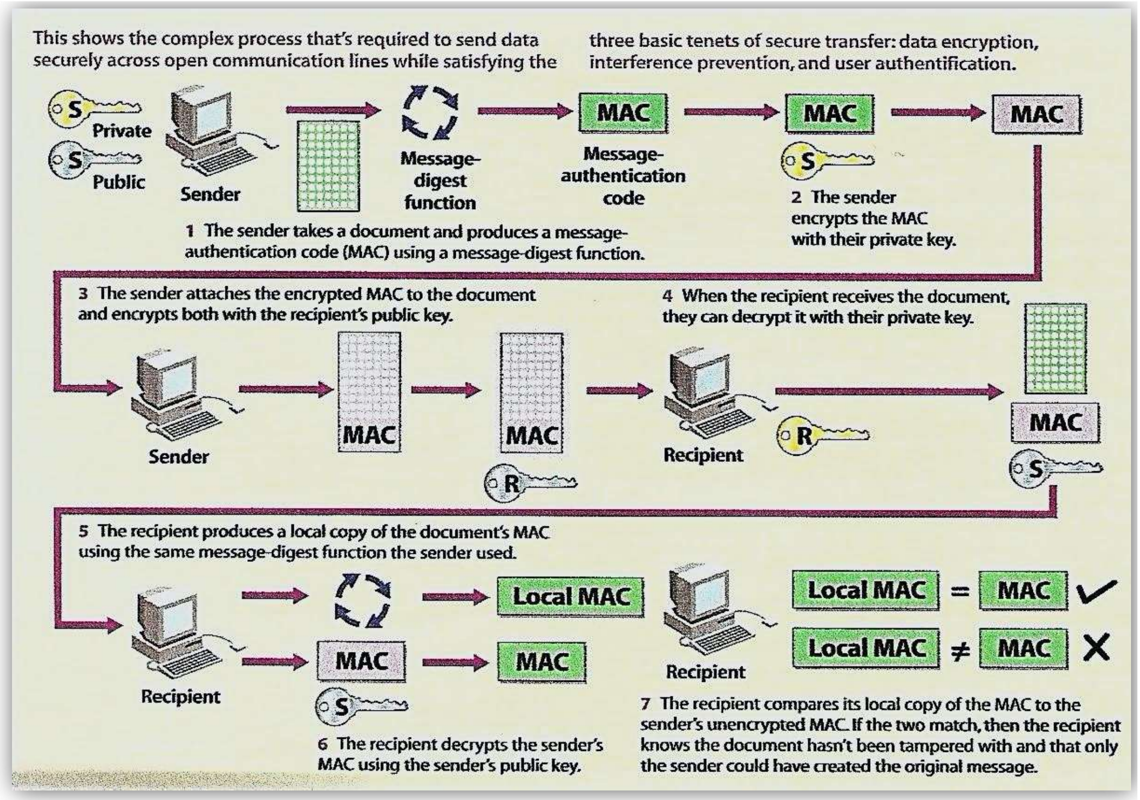
adware | hacker | browser hijacker | malware attack | spyware | trojan | virus | worm



3. Match the security solution 1–5 to its purpose a–e.

1. a firewall	______**a)** prevents damage that viruses might cause
2. antivirus software	______**b)** make sure only authorised people access the network
3. authentication	______**c)** checks the user is allowed to use system
4. username, password and biometric scanning	______**d)** blocks unauthorised access codes
5. encryption	______**e)** protects the system from public access

4. Rewrite the procedures shown below using the passive voice.



1. ____

2. ____

3. ____

4. ____

5. ____

6. ____

7. ____

8. ____

Unit 6 – Customer service

1. Business writing

1.1. Read this letter carefully. Match these labels to the parts of the letter.

a) date	b) job title	c) enclosure	d) references	e) salutation	f) receiver's name and address
g) complimentary close	h) letterhead	i) subject	j) body of the letter	k) signature	

EXECUTIVE TRAINING VIDEOS
1048 Wiltshire Avenue
San Diego - California 92107
Tel.: 555 32 56 / Fax: 555 32 57 / Email: etv_videos@gmail.com **(1)**

Your Ref: BE/HT

Our Ref: MS / IP **(2)**

12 August 2021 **(3)**

Ms Julia Harding

Johnson Engineering

Offley Industrial Park

Birmingham B9 6HL **(4)**

Dear Ms Harding **(5)**

Training Videos (6)

Thank you for your letter of 3 June enquiring about our range of training videos.

Unfortunately, the video you require is temporarily out of stock, but we are expecting some more in the near future. I will contact you again as soon as they arrive.

You may be interested in other items from our product range, and I am enclosing our latest brochure and price list.

Thank you for your interest in our training videos and please do not hesitate to contact me if you have any further questions.

I look forward to hearing from you soon. **(7)**

Yours sincerely **(8)**

Robert Kapferer **(9)**

(Robert Kapferer)

Sales Manager **(10)**

Enc. Current brochure and price list. **(11)**

1.2. Here are some ways to start your message. Complete them:

Dear ______________ or Madam	to a company
Dear ______________	to a man if you do not know his name
Dear Madam	to a ______________ if you do not know her name
Dear ______________ Smith	to a married or unmarried man
Dear ______________ Smith	to a married or unmarried woman
Dear ______________ Smith	to a married woman
Dear ______________ Smith	to an unmarried woman
Dear ______________	to a friend or someone you know well

The way you close a message depends on how you open it.

Dear Sir or Madam	Yours faithfully
Dear + title + surname	Yours sincerely
Dear + first name	Best wishes / Best regards

1.3. Style and conventions: put the words in the sentences below in the correct order and create useful tips for business writing.

a) style / natural / write / a / in /. use / formal / style / not / an / very / do / old-fashioned.

____

____

b) unless / well / not / informal / do / you / person / the / use / very / know / language.

____

____

c) abbreviations / use / as / not / c u soon / text-message / or / do / such / waiting 4 u.

____

____

d) slang / avoid / or / try / emoticons / to.

____

e) in / CAPITALS / write / don't /. are / same / in / email / capitals / shouting / the / as.

____

____

f) into / your / paragraphs / message / divide /. a / message / a / to / paragraph / confusing / and / long / in / single / tiring / is / read /. empty / between / an / paragraphs / put / your / line.

____

____

1.4. Match each sentence / expression on the left with their formal equivalents on the right.

Informal (spoken) language	Formal (written) language
1. Thanks for your letter.	____a) I am writing with reference to the advertisement in…
2. I've just seen your advert in…	____b) due to the fact that
3. Can you tell me about…?	____c) Thank you for your letter dated 14 March.
4. because	____d) Please find enclosed…
5. Sorry, I can't make the meeting.	____e) I am afraid I will not be able to attend the meeting.
6. Here are…	____f) I would be grateful if you could send me some information about…
7. What exactly do you need?	____g) Please return the goods at our expense.
8. Just send the stuff back. We'll pay.	____h) We are pleased to inform you that…
9. I've got some bad news. There's no more until next month.	____i) Please let me know your exact requirements.
10. Good news! I've just heard that…	____j) If you require any further information, please do not hesitate to contact me.
11. There isn't much left. You better move fast.	____ k) We regret to advise you that the goods you require are temporarily out of stock.
12. If you'd like any more details, just let me know.	____l) Please note that our stocks are limited. We advise customers to order as soon as possible to avoid disappointment.

1.5. Complete the following letter and its reply with the correct words / expressions below.

I would be grateful…| I am afraid that… | I am writing to confirm… | Please contact us again if… | Thank you for your help. | Could you possibly…? | I look forward to hearing from… | Thank you for your letter of… | Yours… | I look forward to meeting you… | I am writing to… | I am enclosing… | With reference to… | I would be delighted to… | … sincerely

Dear Mr Hendrickson,

1) ____________________ our telephone conversation today, 2) ____________________ that I will be in Sweden from 11-14 June.

3) ____________________ if you could arrange for me to visit the Technical Department in Stockholm. If possible, I would also like to meet Mr Christianson.

4) ____________________ also send me a list of any hotels near Head Office that you would recommend, and I will make the bookings from here?

5) ____________________.

6) ____________________ you.

7) ____________________ sincerely,

Martin Vernon

Dear Mr Vernon,

8) ____________________ May 21.

9) ____________________ give you details of the arrangements for your visit.

10) ____________________ show you round the Technical Department when you arrive. I have arranged a visit for Monday, June 12 at 11.00 a.m.

11) ____________________ Mr Christianson will not be here when you come, but his assistant, Mr Karlsbad, will be pleased to meet you.

12) ____________________ a list of hotels near Head Office. I would particularly recommend the Sheraton, which most of our visitors enjoy.

13) ____________________ we can help in any way.

14) ____________________ in June.

Yours 15) ____________________,

Karl Hendrickson

1.6. Look at the email below and consider the following questions

a) Who is the sender? And the receiver?

b) Is there a signature? What about a disclaimer?

c) Is the subject line filled in?

d) Has the importance option been used?

e) Has the email been copied to anyone else (using the bcc (blind carbon copy) or cc (carbon copy) field)?

f) What is the purpose of the email?

g) What format would the attachment be in?

h) What is the receiver expected to do?

To: p-vogel@mply.de
From: s.griffrn@travelexpress.com
Cc:
Bcc:
Subject: Sales Manager post (ref. 7672P)

Dear Mr Vogel,

Thank you for your email expressing interest in the above vacancy.

Please confirm whether you would prefer to receive an application form and further details by email (Word or in hard copy by post.

If you have any questions, please do not hesitate to email or phone me.

Yours sincerely,
Stacey Griffin
Personnel Assistant
s.griffin@travelexpress.com

Travel Express
35 Windmill Street
Evesham EN42 TR UK
Tel: +44 (0)1 868 767565 (ext. 392)
Fax: +44 (0)1 868 767600
The content of this email and any attachments sent with it are confidential and for the addressee only. Any unauthorised copying or distribution by anyone else is prohibited. Please delete this email if you have obtained it in error.

1.7. Some companies have guidelines on how staff should use email. Look at the following extract and complete the gaps using words from the previous exercises.

a) Make sure you have the ________________'s address correct. It's easy to send an email to the wrong person.

b) Use the __________________only is someone else needs to be kept informed or to take action.

c) Include the following information in your _______________: your name, job title, company name and address, telephone number.

d) The company's website address and a legal __________________are sometimes automatically added to all outgoing messages.

e) Ensure the __________________clearly describes what the email is about and is free of errors.

f) Do not use Reply all unless you mean to email the whole group.

g) Use the body of the email if possible. If you need to send an ______________, first check with the receiver that the format (Word, etc.) and file size are appropriate.

h) Use the bcc field instead of the ___field to avoid having large numbers of names in the email header, and to avoid making email addresses known to other people.

i) Only use the _________________(high priority) if your email requires quick action, or if others need to receive information from you urgently.

j) Don't forward emails unless the sender has given you permission.

1.8. Match these key terms with their definitions.

a) netiquette	____where you write the topic of your message
b) subject line	____ good-practice guidelines for emailing
c) attachment	____ your contact details below your email
d) to cc someone in	____ a document emailed to someone
e) signature	____ a folder containing messages for you to read
f) format	____ to copy your message to another person
g) in-tray	____type of electronic file (e.g. Word)

1.9. Put the words in the spaces.

attach | browse | field | inboxes | open | send | size

You can send almost any file as an attachment. 1) ________________ through the folders on your computer until you find the file you want to attach. Click on 2) "_____________" The file will appear in the attachments 3)________________. Then click 4) "_________________" and wait while the file uploads. Add more files if you wish. When you have finished adding files, click 5) "_________________".

Some email 6) _________________ will only receive attachments up to a certain 7) _________________ with one email, for example 10MB. If you need to send a lot of very big attachments, it's sometimes necessary to spread them over a number of separate emails.

1.10. Complete this reply to an email enquiring about a software protection system using the prepositions below. You will have to use some of the prepositions more than once.

for | from | in | to | on | with

To: a.newson@123.com
From: varienne@discpro.com
Cc:
Bcc:
Subject: RSP Software (ref. 235)

Dear Ms Newson,

Thank you **1)** ______your email **2)** ______which you expressed an interest **3)** _____the RSP 11 software protection system. Please find attached our latest brochure and price list. **4)** __the information in your email, I can confirm that the range of product we supply would be ideal **5)** ___your needs. In particular, I would like to draw your attention **6)** ______the RSP 11W **7)** ______page 3 which is designed for software protection in both Windows and MacOS environments.

As you will see our protection systems are tailored **8)** ____individual programs. Please let me know whether you would like to arrange a meeting **9)** _____Technical Director to prepare a more detailed report **10)** ____ your program and particular requirements. He will be in London during the week beginning 15 July.
I look forward to hearing **11)** ________you.

Yours sincerely,

2. Computing support

2.1. Networks: Troubleshooting. Before you read the text, talk about these questions:

a) What are some common network problems?

b) What are some common solutions to network problems?

2.2. Read the passage taken from a webpage and answer the questions below.

Troubleshooting network connection problems for wireless networks

It appears that your router is not working, try these steps to resolve first:

- Make sure the wireless router is plugged in to both the power source and the phone jack.
- Check that the wireless adapter on your computer or laptop is enabled.
- If your computer still does not detect a signal, cycle the router by disconnecting it from the power source. Wait 45-60 seconds and plug it in again. The power light should come on first. This will be followed by the light indicating a signal is being received.
- You could also try restarting your computer. Restarting your computer helps clear the web browser's data cache. Clearing the cache may improve the speed of your computer.
- Log in by entering your password when prompted. Wait for the computer to boot up completely.
- Check under network connections to see if an IP address is being detected. The IP address may need to be renewed if it is not TCP/IP compatible. If no address is detected, renew the IP address.

If these suggestions did not solve the problem, contact your ISP.

a) What is the main idea of the webpage?

b) Which solution was suggested?

c) According to the webpage, why is restarting the computer useful?

2.3. Listen to *Troubleshooting 1* [available in Moodle] again and complete these questions:

a) ______________the paper tray ______________?

b) ____the connections?

c) Is it ____________________________?

d) What else should have been checked?

2.4. Listen to *Troubleshooting 2* [available in Moodle] and complete these questions:

a) What happens when you ______________________________?

b) Have you tried ______________________________________?

c) How soon _____________________________?

2.5. Listen to *Troubleshooting 3* [available in Moodle] and answer the following questions.

a) What's missing?

b) Did he save it?

c) What are the possible causes of the problem?

2.6. Explain the problems below and suggest solutions, beginning "Have you tried...?".

a) My computer's running slowly.

b) I can never remember my computer passwords.

c) I receive too much spam.

d) My code isn't working. I keep getting the same bug.

Example:

Student A – My computer is running slowly.

Student B – Have you tried deleting files?

Student A – Yes, but it didn't work.

Student B – Have you tried …-ing?

Student A – Yes, but…

2.7. Listen to a phone call to a company IT help desk. Choose the correct answers a, b or c, to the questions.

1. **What is Tuka's problem?**
   a) can't print out
   b) has lost files
   c) is not connected to the network

2. **How does Tuka sound?**
   a) worried
   b) angry
   c) tired
3. **What is the possible cause of the problem?**
   a) a hardware upgrade
   b) a server problem
   c) a software upgrade

4. **What is the help desk technician's first suggestion?**
   a) go to a folder on the server
   b) go a folder on the desktop
   c) go to a folder on the C drive

5. **What is the help desk technician's second suggestion?**
   a) He will call back in five minutes
   b) He will come down to Tuka's office
   c) He will get help from someone else

2.7.1. Listen again and complete the technician's sentences.

a) How can I _________________you?

b) I_________________.

c) I ' m _________________we can find your file.

d) _________________ go to the search box...

e) Good _________________.

2.8. Read the dialogue below and complete it with the words below.

checked | disconnected | found | go | switched | type | tight | unplugged | worked | working

Haider: Hello, IT Help Desk.

Maryam: Hi, this is Maryam from Human Resources.

Haider: Hi, this is Haider. How can I help you, Maryam?

Maryam: I _______________________[1] my computer off yesterday and today I can't turn it on.

Haider: What _______________________[2] of computer do you have?

Maryam: I'm not sure. It's a desktop computer. It ____________________[3] fine yesterday.

Haider: Don't worry. Have you __________________[4] the cable connections?

Maryam: No, I haven't. I can see some cables but I don't know which cable goes where.

Haider: Make sure all cables are __________________[5] and fully plugged in.

Maryam: Ok, give me a sec. Oh, I think I've _________________[6] the problem. I have one cable that is ___________________[7]. It's the power cable. Where does it go?

Haider: The power cable should __________________[8] in the three-pronged port on the computer.

Maryam: OK, done. Let me try now. It's _________________[9] fine. Sorry about that. Stupid of me.

Haider: Maybe the cleaners __________________[10] your PC by mistake last night.

Maryam: Maybe. Good, we've solved the problem. Thank you, Haider.

Haider: You're welcome. Have a good day.

Maryam: You too.

2.9. There are several ways to advise someone to do something:

- Using an imperative: Try to reinstall the sound drivers.
- Using the modal verb 'should': You should reinstall the sound drivers.
- Using 'recommend': I recommend reinstalling the sound drivers. / I recommend that you reinstall the sound drivers.
- Using 'advise': I advise you to reinstall the sound drivers.
- Or phrases such as: The best thing to do is to reinstall the sound drivers.

Study the steps to take before phoning for technical support. Rewrite each one using the clue given.

a) Reboot your PC to see if the problem recurs. (should)

____

b) Use your PC's on-board diagnostic and repair tools. (strongly recommend)

____

c) Record the details of the problem so you can describe it accurately. (good idea)

____

d) Note your system's model name and serial number. (advise)

____

e) Avoid phoning in peak times. (never)

____

f) Have your system up and running and be near it when you call. (best thing)

____

2.10. Create a telephone dialogue in which a help desk technician advises a user (you). The problem and the computer specifications are given below. Each person should speak at least 5 times.

PROBLEM: Your computer is running slow

SYSTEM:

Make and model: Dell Desktop PC Vostro 3681 i7 10700

Processor: Intel Core i7 (i7 10700)

Memory: 8 GB

SSD 512 GB

Intel® UHD Graphics 630

OS: Windows 10 Pro

Service Number: 9876CDX

2.11. Complete the text using the words in the boxes. (v) shows you that you need a verb and (n) shows you that you need a noun.

verbs (v): press | click | sign in | type | add | log off | set up | plug in

nouns (n): cursor | icon | username | password | request | drop-down menu | account

THE SILVER SURFER'S SEVEN STEPS TO SKYPE HEAVEN

In this article, we'll show you how to talk to a friend on Skype.

Tip: You can only do this when you've downloaded the software and ______________________[1](v) an ______________________[2] (n).

STEP ___– Now you've ______________________[3](v), you need some people to talk to! In the search bar on the top left-hand side of the screen, type the name of the friend you would like to ______________________[4](v) and press 'search'.

STEP ___ – Use the mouse to move the ______________________ [5](n). When all the icons are displayed on the screen, ______________________ [6](v) on the Skype icon. It looks like a blue cloud with an 'S'.

STEP ___- If your friend answers the call, you should now be able to see them and talk to them. When you've finished the conversation, click on the red phone icon to end the call. To ______________________ [7](v), click on the ______________________[8](n) in the top left-hand corner called 'Skype' and click 'sign out'. Happy Skyping!

STEP ___ – Make sure the laptop is ______________________[9](v). Open the laptop and ______________________ [10](v) the 'on' button to start up the computer.

STEP ___- A box should appear in the middle of the screen. ______________________[11](v) in your ______________________[12](n) and ______________________[13](n). Press 'enter' to log on.

Tip: Use a password you can easily remember so you don't have to write it down but try not to make it too easy to guess!

STEP _ – Once your friend accepts your request, you can start chatting. Simply click on your friend's picture and then on the ______________________[14](n) that looks like a blue circle with a picture of a camera to make a video call.

STEP ___- When you find your friend, press 'send ______________________[15](n)'. Tip: If there is more than one person with that name, look at the photographs.

2.11.1. Put the steps in the correct order.

2.12. You are now going to role-play a situation with your partner, using the vocabulary you have learned. Decide which role you would like to play.

Role card A – Grandmother or grandfather

• You live in a retirement home. Sometimes, you feel very lonely.

• You wish you could talk to your old friends but they all live very far away and you have difficulty understanding modern technology.

• Today is your 80th birthday. You have a visitor ...

Role card B – Granddaughter or grandson

• You are going to visit your grandmother or grandfather, who lives in a retirement home.

• Today is her or his 80th birthday. You have brought her/ him a new laptop as a present, although you aren't sure if he or she knows how to use it.

• Try to explain how it works.

Unit 7 – A Career in IT

1. Read the text and unscramble the given words to fill in the gaps in the text.

How do I get into a career in IT?

If you want to get into a high-level IT job you have a choice of routes. You can go to university or start work at 18 and earn while you learn.

There are IT jobs available at all different levels, depending on your ________________________ [1] **(quationslicafi)** and _______________________ [2] **(exienperce)**. If you're doing well academically at school or college it makes sense to start a little way up the ladder, either by going to university and then getting a graduate-level job, or by starting work after your **A levels** (or equivalent) with an _________________________ [3] **(mpeolyer)** who will train you up - for example by putting you through a **higher _______________________** [4] **(shipapprentice)**.

Uni first, job later

There are plenty of IT-related ______________________ [5] **(greedes)** available. However, you can get into an IT career at graduate level whatever subject you study at university.

Studying for an IT degree

Studying for an **IT degree** will mean that there are more technology jobs you can **apply for** once you graduate than if you choose a different subject. Lots of employers specify that graduates applying for technical jobs need to have studied for a degree such as computer science or software engineering.

However, if you'd prefer to have more of a commercial focus there are courses such as computing in business available. There's also a wide range of more _____________________ [6] **(spelistcia) courses** if you want to focus on an area such as computer games design, network engineering, artificial intelligence, digital media or animation.

Studying for a non-IT degree: you can still have a technology career

It's possible to get into an IT career as a graduate with any subject. However, you may find fewer employers who will accept your degree and more _________________________ [7] **(titioncompe)** for positions.

Broadly speaking, the less technical your degree the more competition you will face and the more impressive you will need to be as a candidate. This includes having a strong **academic** _________________________ [8] **(cordre)**. If you want to go into IT via this route, make sure you do as well as you can in your A levels, get into a good university and study a degree ________________________ [9] **(jectsub)** that you think you will do well in and that is academically well respected. Think about what you can do in your spare time to develop and display your interest in IT or _________________________ [10] **(nolotechgy)**, such as learning to code.

Getting into IT: starting work at 18

Higher apprenticeships, **degree apprenticeships** and **sponsored degrees** are well worth a look if you want to start work in IT after your A levels (or equivalent) and study towards higher level qualifications at the same time.

Earning and learning: IT degree apprenticeships and sponsored degree programmes

There are a handful of _________________________[11]**(tiesniopportu)** to complete an IT degree while working for an employer, usually called a degree apprenticeship or sponsored degree. You'll earn a _________________________ [12] **(gawe)** and have your studies paid for, meaning that you can _________________________[13] **(duagrate)** debt-free and with several years of _________________________ [14] **(luavable)** professional experience on your CV.

Other apprenticeship programmes lead to a ______________________[15] **(fountionda)** degree, which is not as high level as a degree, but still a recognised qualification.

1.1. What is the difference between qualifications and experience? Organise the words/phrases to find the definitions.

Qualifications are ____

____

____ or have the necessary skills for a job/position.

course | showing | that | records | you | have finished | official | a | training

---

Experience refers to ____

____

____

___________________. It provides a context for and adds to the qualifications.

have had | the opportunities | you | to acquire | skills | and | develop

1.2. Match the qualifications in the box to the definitions below.

(Undergraduate) degree | Specialist course | Higher apprenticeship | Sponsored degree

a) _________________- A vocational level 4-5 qualification that can take from 1 to 5 years to complete, and involve part-time study at a college, university, or training provider.

b) _________________- Qualification obtained by a person who has completed undergraduate courses. It is usually offered at an institution of higher education, such as a university.

c) _________________- Intensive work and study programme in which an employer provides financial support to students in specific areas. Typically, the student will complete work placements with the employer and may need to work for the sponsor for a minimum period after graduation.

d) _________________- Technically and professionally oriented programmes that concentrate on a particular area or field.

2. Read the following text and answer the questions below.

A career in IT

Most people taking this course are either **studying for** their first job in IT, or else trying to improve their current IT career. Sometimes the hardest part of **meeting a goal** is to properly define what you are trying to accomplish in the first place. In this article we will discuss the top IT job positions available around the world right now. So, read the rest of the article, reflect on which career most suits your personality... and then go for it!

There are several things to keep in mind when determining what field of IT to go into. Keep an eye on job web sites such as DICE.com or Monster.com to see which jobs are most in-demand. Keep in mind that for many jobs described below, there are several levels of positions available. For instance, there are "junior", "senior", and "lead" software developer positions available. You probably can't start out you career as a lead developer. You have to know your own limits.

Be honest with yourself. If you don't have previous experience, good contacts, or a good degree from a well-known university, you will be more successful in getting a lower-level job. Also, find out what the job you are applying for typically pays in your area. If you are young, living in a financially depressed area, or really need a job, keep your salary expectations a bit lower than the average. This will make your chances much higher than normal to get hired. Once you have "job experience" then you will be in a good position to ask for more money. And how do you show your IT manager that you are a good performer? Easy. Show up on time, be dependable, be active in the meetings, and always do a little bit more than is asked of you. Also equally important is to be well-liked by members of your team. Read on for more details...

Learn something new every day

IT is an area where people are judged largely by how much they know. If money and a high job position are important to you, you can quickly raise your level by telling your manager that you want harder tasks and more responsibility. IT Managers normally love it when employees ask for more responsibility. When you meet with your manager, set goals for yourself and meet or exceed those goals. Here are some things you can do to increase your worth to your company:

- learn a new programming language
- take a certification such a Microsoft, Linux Professional Institute, or Cisco
- study to be a Scrum Master or another type of project manager.

Appearance and attitude are very important!

Take an active interest in things outside IT, such as sports, politics, music, and film. This will make socializing at company events easier for you. If you are disliked in the company then you will not get promotions or important projects.

Be courteous, helpful, and respectful to others

Keep in mind that there are some good IT departments and some bad ones. In a good IT department, the engineers are known for sharing knowledge and helping each other. In bad IT departments, the engineers are secretive and hide knowledge. How can everyone get better if some people are selfish with what they know? Information wants to be free. You must set it free. Despite the fact that you have been to university or graduate school, and have collected many IT certifications, you can learn a lot about IT from your coworkers. So be kind and respect your fellow IT staff. They are your family for eight hours every day, forty hours every week!

Have your own mind and your own opinions

State your opinions in meetings and give good reasons and facts to back up your opinions. But don't be stubborn or insistent if things don't go your way.

IT positions

CTO (Chief Technical Officer), **CIO** (Chief Information Officer) Qualities: business savvy, technical mind-set, good people skills	**Enterprise Architect** Qualities: good technical, business, and design skills
Technical Writer Qualities: excellent writing skills, good technical mind	**Software Developer** Qualities: creative, persistent, insatiable thirst for knowledge
Project Manager Qualities: cooperation, leadership, and organization skills	**Database Developer / Database Administrator** Qualities: detail-oriented, high business knowledge
IT Security Manager Qualities: defensive, pro-active	**System Administrator** Qualities: detail-oriented, organized, and reliable
Software Tester Qualities: detail-oriented, persistent, and curious	**IT Support Engineer** Qualities: technical mind-set, and good people skills

a) According to the text, what should you keep in mind when deciding the field of IT you want to work in?

b) How can you work your way up in a company?

3. Match the words and phrases (1-8) with the definitions (A-H).

1. focus ______
2. ability ______
3. logical ______
4. curious ______
5. dedicated ______
6. team player ______
7. outside the box ______
8. critical thinking ______

A. the skill to do something
B. wanting to know more about something
C. related to unusual or creative ideas
D. the skill of drawing conclusions based on facts
E. enthusiastic about a task or cause
F. based on evidence and reason
G. someone who takes actions to benefit a group
H. to watch closely

4. Complete these definitions with the jobs from the box.

software engineer | help desk technician | DTP operator | network administrator | tester | computer systems analyst | computer security specialist

a) A ________________________ uses page layout software to prepare electronic files for publication.

b) A ________________________manages the hardware and software that comprise a network.

c) A ________________________works with companies to build secure computer systems.

d) A ________________________helps end-users with their computer problems in person, by email or over the phone.

e) A ________________________ studies an organization's **computer systems** and procedures, and designs solutions to help it operate more efficiently and effectively.

f) A ________________________is responsible for designing, maintaining, testing and evaluating computer software.

g) A ________________________ professional who uses products to determine how well they function.

5. There are different skills that are important when applying for a job. Try to find out the difference between these:

- **Technical/specialist skills:**

- **Transferable skills:**

- **Soft skills:**

6. According to the text above, one way of increasing your worth in a company is studying "to be a Scrum master". A scrum master is the facilitator for an agile development team. A good Scrum master should have good organizational and technical skills, as well as demonstrate teaching and coaching abilities. This means they should be able to keep an entire team on schedule and encourage members to improve their skills and work together. These skills are often referred to as "transferable skills". **Match the transferable skills (1-8) to the examples of professional behaviour.**

1. analytical skills	____a)	I have a justified belief in my ability to do the job. I am able to express my opinion or provide advice when necessary. I am good at making decisions.
2. creativity	____b)	I actively seek feedback on my performance and carefully consider feedback. I demonstrate an interest in and understanding of my own and other cultures. I understand my own strengths and limitations.
3. self-confidence	____c)	I am good at getting a good deal. I am good at developing and managing relationships with others. I am able to persuade, convince and gain support from others.
4. communication skills	____d)	I am able to formulate new ideas to solve problems. I am able to think ahead to spot or create opportunities. I set aside thinking time to come up with alternative ways of getting things done more efficiently.
5. independence	____e)	I can work with sustained energy and determination on my own. I can find ways to overcome obstacles to set myself achievable goals. I strive towards my own targets and refuse to settle for second best.
6. interpersonal skills	____f)	I am good at data analysis. I am excellent at interpreting data to see cause and effect and am able to use this information to make effective decisions.
7. negotiation skills	____g)	I am able to express myself creatively. I am able to make my opinions totally clear and I am rarely misunderstood. I produce clear, well-written reports that can be easily understood.
8. self-awareness	_____h)	I am good at working collaboratively. I am good at working and communicating with a team to achieve shared goals. I am a good listener.

6.1. Identify 3 key transferable skills, which you believe are important in your area of studies. Give examples.

7. Read the following texts and answer the questions below.

Whether you are looking for a **part-time job** while you are still at school or university or a **full-time job** after finishing your studies, there are many different ways to find out about job opportunities.

Press/Internet

Recruitment ads can be **published in** the printed press, such as local, national and international newspapers, and on their websites. Some papers have a specific day for recruitment and/or different sectors. Websites **dedicated to** job hunting, like indeed.com, simplyhired.com and monster.com, are also very popular. Some sites are free to use while others charge a fee.

Company websites

Companies also advertise their vacancies on their websites, so it is a good idea to look at these frequently, especially when you are interested in a specific sector or company.

Recruitment agencies

Companies can also use private recruitment agencies to **carry out** the selection process on their behalf. These agencies advertise the position in their agency, on their website and through the other means mentioned here. They can then either send all the candidates' CVs to the company for review or make an initial selection.

They may also carry out preliminary interviews in order to present only a small group of candidates for final interview at the company. Some recruitment agencies are **specialised in** temporary or short-term positions.

Job Centre Plus

In the UK you can contact one of the many Job Centre Plus offices, which are publicly funded agencies **aimed at** helping people find a job, often those that have been unemployed for some time.

They provide lots of different services and support and also have a huge online database of vacancies.

Headhunters

Headhunters, who can work independently or as part of an agency, can be used to fill executive, well-paid positions, where very specific skills and a lot of experience are required. Headhunters often have a list of potential high-profile candidates who they can quickly propose for a position. They can also act more aggressively, hunting for talented people in competitors' companies and then contacting them directly to propose a career move.

It is also possible to write to a company directly, proposing yourself for a certain type of job based on your experience, or even to place your own advert.

a) What kind of website in indeed.com?

b) In what different ways can a recruitment agency carry out a job search for a company?

c) What is the main difference between a recruitment agency and Job Centre Plus?

d) What is the main difference between a recruitment agency and a headhunter?

e) How do headhunters find potential candidate for a job?

8. Social networks

Networking is one of the most important components of job searching. In fact, some reports state that 70% of all jobs are found through networking, with at least 84% of employers using social platforms, such as Facebook and LinkedIn, as a recruitment tool.

There are many ways to use social media to network and eventually find a job. In fact, not only can you find a job with this medium, but also create and cultivate a professional brand using social networking sites, building a strategic online presence to help with your job searching and career building.

Watch the video Are Facebook posts hurting your career? and answer these questions:

a) Why do recruiters look at a candidate's profile on Facebook?

b) Why are some candidates rejected?

c) Why is it not possible to rely on privacy settings to protect yourself?

8.1. What do you know about Instagram and LinkedIn? Use the following information to fill in the gaps.

2003 | 2010 | Facebook | 706 million | business and create job opportunities | 1 billion | B2C | B2B | job-related information | 15-24 year | photos, videos, promotional basics | people and upload media |

25-34 year | Microsoft Corporation

	LinkedIn	Instagram
Launch		
Ownership	It is parented by ________________.	It is owned and parents by _________.
Purpose	It is a platform to generate _________ _________________________.	It is a platform to connect with ______ _________________________.
Users		
User's age	mainly ____________age group	mainly ____________age group
Interaction	To post _______________________ _________________________.	To post _______________________ _________________________.
Main industry impact		

sources: Ask Any Difference (2021)

9. LinkedIn. Watch the video and answer the questions. (*Lauren's List: Do's & Don'ts for Your LinkedIn Account* by CBS Miami)

a) What percentage of recruiters have hired someone through LinkedIn?

b) How many people have found a job through this site?

c) What can we add to the headline to spice it up?

d) How to make our summary section more interesting?

e) Who can we ask for recommendations?

f) What should our skills and endorsements reflect?

10. LinkedInn profile – mind your language!

Watch out for spelling mistakes & typos

Studies have shown that one out of four emploiers will pass on your resume or LinkedIn profille if they find mispellings. Ask your friends or teachers to read the text that is going to be posted; they might notice typos you didn't sea!

a. Underline and correct the four (4) spelling mistakes in the text above.

Avoid repeating adjectives

The best way to describe your skills is with adjectives. If you feel stuck with the same adjectives, visit Thesaurus.com or Yourdictionary.com for synonyms.

In fact, having a wide variety of them always make profiles more appealing, e.g.:

I am ambitious, self-confident, insightful, and empathetic towards others.

b. Identify a synonym for the adjectives of the sentence above.

Provide an inviting and professional headline

You headline in LinkedIn plays a critical role. It should communicate your expertise, your field and why you are special and help recruiters determine if they want to read your profile or not. Think of your headline as an ad: informative, engaging and eye-catching.

If you don't create your own headline the site will automatically make it your current job title and employer. Examples:

- IT specialist and network wizard
- Network specialist seeking internship
- Junior Programmer and aspiring Tech Lead
- Future network specialist studying for a technical diploma
- IT student and professional network calls killer

c. What's your professional headline? Looking for some good adjectives? Check the ResumeCompanion.

____

[positive adjective + field of study/ profession]

Make sure to state your field of study or profession with some positive adjectives, for instance *Ambitious Marketing Specialist.*

Use strong verbs to state your skills

Using verbs to describe skills and accomplishments tend to make a person seem more confident in their work and experience. Instead of writing "great experience in writing business plans", it looks much better to write "wrote successful business plans". Money-Zine.com has created a very useful list of power verbs to use on your profile.

d. Rewrite the following sentence with the expressions provided below.

- I used to figure out important business cases so our company could create new products.
- I was____ ____of new pro

business cases | *meaningful* | *responsible for* | *our company's launch* | *developing* | *to support*

Avoid contractions

Contractions tend to make sentences more informal; aim to use more "I am" and "is not", and less "I'm" and "isn't". There are abbreviations, though, that can be used, such as the ones below.

e. Match the abbreviations (1-6) with their meanings (a-f).

1. e.g.		**a)** that is (to say)
2. i.e.		**b)** approximately
3. esp.		**c)** as soon as possible
4. approx.		**d)** for instance
5. no		**e)** especially
6. asap		**f)** number

Use formal language and business wording

It is important to keep in mind that formal language is more appropriate in a professional environment. Always avoid the use of slang.

Changing just one single word can make a sentence more formal, for example:

"Able to create a variety of written content, such as articles, news releases…"

is more formal than

"Able to create a variety of written content, like articles, news releases…"

f. Complete the following table using the words in the box below.

position | ensure | currently | chance | about | tell | want

INFORMAL	FORMAL
at the moment	1. ____________________
2. ____________________	would like
3. ____________________	concerning / regarding
make sure	4. ____________________
5. ____________________	inform
job	6. ____________________
7. ____________________	opportunity

11. LinkedIn – Summary

The summary is one of the most important areas of your LinkedIn profile. A good summary should sum up your professional history, qualifications and personality and make potential recruiters notice you. Avoid using LinkedIn's automatically generated summary.

Note that the best LinkedIn examples are short. According to research, people are going to skim through your profile opposed to reading it fully. So, make sure to include:

- Bulleted lists
- Plenty of white space
- Brief sentences

Basic Summary Format

1. Introduction: Who are you? What is your brand statement? Get the reader's attention!
2. Background: Summary of education, experience, companies, organizations;
3. Uniqueness: What are your specialties, key strengths or top skills? How are you unique?
4. Academic/Career Achievements: 3-5 key achievements from college or work;
5. Call to Action: Contact information, invitation to visit your website/portfolio
6. Specialties: Almost like a footnote, a great place for keywords

Examples

A. Innovative tech mind and java programmer seeking opportunities to work as a web developer. Capable of working with a variety of technology and software solutions, including Java, C++ and Python. Valuable team member with experience in diagnosing problems and finding solutions.

Areas of expertise include:

- Advanced knowledge in computer development software including C++ and Python;
- Database software such as MySQL, Hadoop, Sybase, and MongoDB.

Highly organized professional with exceptional commitment to task completion and quality assurance when working with computer software program. I also have excellent communication and listening skills and a strong understanding of stress and time management techniques. Please feel free to check my GitHub profile - https://github.com/ttar or contact me at 406-123-4567, ttar@ua.pt.

B. I am a creative and highly motivated second year Network and Computer Systems student at ESTGA with an interest in network technology and infrastructure and LAN topologies. I am currently seeking an internship to apply my experience designing, installing and maintaining local networks.
Specialties:

- Linux and Windows servers;
- Routing, Switching and Security

Please feel free to connect with me or contact me at jdoe@ua.pt

TIPS

Make sure to proofread your summary. Remember, your LinkedIn summary is available for the entire world to view. Once you've written your summary, don't post it without proofreading it and getting a trusted friend, professor, or mentor to look it over. Ideally, find someone who works in an industry that interests you and get them to proofread it and offer feedback. Here are some mistakes to watch out for (including ones that spell-checking programs don't always catch):

Spelling of company names - If you worked at a particular company and you want to mention it in your summary, make sure the name is spelled correctly.

Your vs you're and **there, their, and they're** - These are easy mistakes to make when you're typing fast.

Its vs it's - Another common mistake to avoid.

Complete the following LinkedIn profile template.

	Name: Headline:

Summary

sources (abridged and adapted):
How does your LinkedIn profile rate?, https://www.phoenix.edu/alumni/phoenix-focus/linkedin-appeal-quiz.html
10 English tips on how to create a perfect LinkedIn profile, https://www.ilac.com/10-english-tips-on-how-to-create-a-perfect-linkedin-profile/

12. Personal branding. How to Discover and Create your brand. Read the article and choose the correct alternative.

How to Discover and Create Your Brand

Many people think that personal branding is just for celebrities, yet each and every one of us is a brand. Personal branding, by definition, is the process by which we market ourselves to others. As a brand, we can leverage the same strategies that make these celebrities or corporate brands appeal to others.

First you have to think about what face you want to show to the world and how you want to position yourself for success. Then you need to think about creating your brand. You can use these tools to highlight your brand and allow people to easily view what you're about.

Business card: it doesn't matter if you are a college student, CEO or a consultant, everyone should have their own business card.

Email address: Your email address poses a great opportunity for your brand, so use something as: firstname.lastname@mail.com rather than using silly expressions and nicknames.

Blog/Website: You need to own a domain or a website that aligns with your name in some fashion. If you have enough time, you can also start a blog. Bloggers will be at an advantage because they rank higher in search engines and lend more to your expertise and interest areas over time.

LinkedIn, Facebook and Twitter profiles: Develop these carefully, paying attention to things like privacy settings, using the same photo/avatar on all of them and linking your profiles to your blog or website.

Your CV and covering letter are the typical documents for applying for a job. They can be enhanced by a video CV and a portfolio. These are great ways of showcasing the work you've done in the past, which can convince someone of your ability to accomplish the same results for the future.

Source: www.mashable.com

- **a)** Personal branding *is/is not* reserved for celebrities.
- **b)** An individual *can/cannot* use the same tactics as a company for branding.
- **c)** It is crucial to think about what image to present to *everyone/only to employers*.
- **d)** A business card is *sometimes/always* important.
- **e)** A sensible email address is *better/worse* for your brand than a ridiculous one.
- **f)** If you have a blog, you *will/will not* be at an advantage.
- **g)** Your social networks profiles *should/ should not* be linked.
- **h)** A portfolio shows the work you *want to do/have done*.

13. The CV. Listen to this recruitment manager talking about current trends in preparing a CV. Complete the missing information.

Different types of CV

One-page CV

Good design, (1) ______________________ and printed on quality paper

Useful for (2) ____________________________________ and networking contacts

Business card CV

Innovative idea for (3) ______________________

Include contact details, (4) ______________________ and key skills and achievements

Screen-friendly CV

Use (5) _____________________ and bold font to make it easy to read.

Be concise

Job board CV

Include (6) ___________________________, but without exaggerating

Video CV

Must be (7) ______________________ made in order to make the right impression

14. Letter of application. Complete this introduction using the words in the table.

business | complement | cover letter | CV | employer | interview |

persuade | position | well-focused

What is a letter of application?

A 1) ___________________________ gives information about the educational qualifications and professional experience you have, whereas a letter of application - or 2) ___________________________ - explains why you want the job. A letter of application should 3) _________________, not duplicate, your CV. The main purpose of a personalised cover letter is to 4) ___________________________ the reader to read your CV and consider you for the vacant 5) ___________________________.

A cover letter is often your earliest written contact with a potential 6) _____________, creating a critical first impression. A well-written, 7) ________________ cover letter demonstrates your written communication skills and will help you to get that all-important 8) ___________________________.

The letter of application should follow the general guidelines for all 9) ___________________________ letters. It should have an introduction, a main body, and a final paragraph.

15. There are several IT jobs available online. Here are some examples of useful websites in your area:

- http://www.cwjobs.co.uk/
- http://www.theitjobboard.com/
- http://www.theitjob.com/
- http://www.computingcareers.co.uk/

For our simulation, choose one job advertisement that you find interesting or use the one below and apply for it by creating your CV and a letter of application. You can find some suggestions below.

Job Type:	Permanent
Job Location:	Lymm (Cheshire, North West, United Kingdom)
Job Salary:	£15000 - £18000 per annum
Posted On:	20 September 2021
Job Description:	A Technical Analyst is required to join a UK based leading supplier of core to edge network design, installation and support solutions. They are a company that believes in the possibilities of what can be achieved through connecting, people applications and technology to deliver business efficiency or a return on investment.
Responsibilities:	Within this role you will be responsible for the delivery and support of technical solutions and support to their end customers. Key tasks of the role include first / second line support, basic network and application support, project installation, testing, documentation, post-sales support and troubleshooting under the guidance of their senior technicians. Working closely as part of an internal team you will be responsible for the delivering to their customers the high-quality technical support that they deserve. They currently support a diverse range of technologies and as such formal and hands on technical training and development will ensure you develop and grow to support their technical offering.

source: http://www.theitjob.com/

Here are some useful expressions to write cover letters:

A. OPENING

- I am applying for the position of software developer that was advertised in the Bangkok Post of 1 November.
- I am writing in response to your advertisement in the Bangkok Post of 31 October for a support technician.
- I am writing to apply for the post of IT manager advertised in the Thai Rath of 30 October.
- I saw your advertisement for a helpdesk supervisor in The Nation of 31 October.
- I am responding to the CTO vacancy posted on October 30 on your Web site.

B. BODY

- I believe my long experience in managing helpdesk teams makes me a strong candidate for the post.
- As you can see from my enclosed résumé, I believe my experience and qualifications match this position's requirements. I worked at .... as an assistant IT manager for two years.
- As you can see from my enclosed résumé, I am a recent IT graduate of Dhurakij Pundit University, and my grade average point (GPA) was 3.8. I am now looking for a challenging work environment like that at UCOM Company.

C. CLOSING

- I am available for interview any day of the week.
- I look forward to hearing from you soon.
- I look forward to meeting with you soon.
- I look forward to discussing this position with you.
- I have enclosed my résumé and I would like to schedule an interview.

Follow these steps to write your letter of application:

Paragraph one: reason for writing (*I am writing to apply for the position of…*)

Paragraph two: qualifications/education and training (*I graduated in… / I completed my degree in…*)

Paragraph three: work experience/ transferable skills (*For the past X years I have been… / Since X I have been…*)

Paragraph four: soft/ transferable skills (*I spent X months in…* (country), so I have knowledge of… (foreign languages) / I can…) / reasons why you are applying for this job (*I now feel ready to… and would welcome the opportunity to…*)

Paragraph five: closing / availability for interview (*I enclose… /I look forward to… / I will be available for an interview…*)

16. Job interviews. Watch the video Interview Dos and Don'ts [available in Moodle] and complete the table below.

	DOs	DON'Ts
1. Dressing		
2. Body language (handshake, sitting style, behaviour, etc.)		

17. Prepare positive and effective answers to these typical interview questions:

a) Why do you want to work here?

b) What makes you the right person for the job?

c) What are your strengths/weaknesses?

d) Where do you see yourself in five years' time?

e) Tell me about yourself.

f) What's your favourite app? Which are its pros and cons?

18. Creating your 30-60 second Elevator Pitch

Creating an effective verbal message to introduce yourself to an employer is very important - it should help them understand how you can be an asset to an organisation. You should provide the following information:

a. Identification + qualifications + what you can offer a potential employer

Hello, my name is [NAME]. I will be graduating (have recently graduated) in [AREA]. From the [HIGHER EDUCATION INSTITUTION].

I have experience in [FIELD].

My qualifications (or skills) include [e.g. teamwork, communication skills…].

b. Description of interests + desired work/career opportunity

I am gathering information about career opportunities in [FIELD].

or

I am seeking an opportunity to make a contribution to a company by [SPECIFY].

c. Return conversation to the employer + bring closure to your pitch.

Can you tell me more about [FIELD].

or

What would you expect from a person hired as a [POSITION] in your company?

Nice to meet you in person. May I send you my resume to you as follow-up?

source: Elevator Speech

19. Twitter Pitch. A Twitter Pitch or Twesume is a short bio or CV condensed into 140 characters or less. Twesumes help job seekers get noticed by companies who use social recruiting. With it, a job seeker can introduce himself and engage with an employer in less than a traditional resume and cover letter. **Write your Twitter Pitch using the prompts below.**

[POSITION/ EXPERIENCE]. Recent grad. [SKILLS]. [UNIQUE LINE ABOUT WHAT MAKES YOU STANDOUT]. Please RT.

For more information on "TWESUMES"

20. Pixar Pitch. If you had to frame your career, what would you say? A pixar Pitch is a career-related story frame through which you (the hero) can describe your backstory, and project the bright future your work brings about. **Write your Pixar Pitch using the prompts below.**

Once upon a time [INTRODUCE YOURSELF].

Every day, [ESTABLISH THE WAY THINGS WERE].

One day [INTRODUCE INCIDENT].

Because of that [CHALLENGE]

Because of that [SEARCH FOR SOLUTION]

Until finally [FINDS SOLUTION]

Now, [ESTABLISH THE WAY THINGS ARE BETTER NOW]

sources (abridged and adapted):

Elevator Speech, https://d30i16bbj53pdg.cloudfront.net/students/business-career-services/wp-content/uploads/2017/01/30-60-second-Commercial-handout-Copy.jpg Twesumes, https://www.brazen.com/blog/archive/job-search/your-guide-to-applying-for-a-job-in-150-characters-or-